

72nd BPSC PRELIMS

प्रहार

Test Series

Test-12

Modern History 02

Solution

English



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BPSC TEST-12 (SOLUTION)

Q 1. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Unionist Party, formally known as the Punjab National Unionist Party, emerged as the dominant political force in Punjab and formed the government following the provincial elections of 1937. The party had been founded in 1923 by Sir Fazl-i-Husain, with the active collaboration of Chaudhary Chhotu Ram representing Hindu Jat interests and Sir Sikandar Hayat Khan representing Muslim landed interests. Its ideological foundation was distinctive and deliberate; rather than organising along religious lines as most other political formations of the era did, the Unionist Party built its support base around agrarian and landed interests, cutting across the religious divide of Muslims, Hindus, and Sikhs who shared common economic interests as rural proprietors and zamindars of Punjab.
- In the 1937 elections, the Unionist Party won a decisive majority in the Punjab Legislative Assembly, and Sir Sikandar Hayat Khan, who had become the party's leader following Fazl-i-Husain's declining health, formed the government. The party's success demonstrated that in Punjab's particular socio-economic context, class and agrarian identity could override religious identity as the primary basis of political mobilisation. The Unionist government maintained its cross-communal character through a coalition arrangement, the Sikandar-Jinnah Pact of 1937, whereby Punjab Muslim League members in the assembly agreed to support the Unionist government, though the Unionist Party itself retained its distinct identity separate from the All India Muslim League.

Q 2. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The correct chronological sequence places the Provincial Elections first, followed by the Wardha Scheme, then the National Planning Committee, and finally the Resignation of Congress Ministries.
- The Provincial Elections under the Government of India Act, 1935, were held in February 1937, marking the first major exercise of provincial self-governance under the new constitutional framework. Congress contested these elections and won decisive majorities in several provinces,

eventually forming ministries in July 1937 after resolving its initial deadlock with the British over the governors' special powers.

- The Wardha Scheme of Basic Education was followed in October 1937, when Gandhi convened the All India National Education Conference at Wardha. The Zakir Hussain Committee was subsequently formed to work out the detailed curriculum, and the scheme was formally articulated as a comprehensive craft-centred educational philosophy over the following months.
- The National Planning Committee was formed in 1938, under the chairmanship of Jawaharlal Nehru, by the Indian National Congress at its Haripura Session presided over by Subhas Chandra Bose. It was constituted to develop a blueprint for India's economic development and industrialisation, bringing together experts, scientists, industrialists, and Congress leaders to deliberate on planned economic development for independent India.
- The Resignation of the Congress Ministries occurred in October-November 1939, following Viceroy Linlithgow's unilateral declaration of India's participation in World War II without consulting elected Indian representatives, which prompted the Congress Working Committee to direct all its provincial ministries to resign.

Q 3. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Pirpur Report and the Shareef Report were both documents produced by the All India Muslim League to catalogue alleged grievances and complaints of Muslims living under Congress provincial ministries during 1937-39.
- The Pirpur Report, formally titled the Report of the Enquiry Committee of the All India Muslim League, was prepared in 1938 under the chairmanship of Raja Mohammad Mehdi of Pirpur. It compiled a detailed list of allegations against Congress ministries in various provinces, claiming that Muslims were subjected to cultural suppression, economic discrimination, and political marginalisation under Congress rule. Specific grievances included the imposition of the Bande Mataram song, which the League argued contained Hindu religious symbolism unacceptable to Muslims, the promotion of Hindi in the Devanagari script over Urdu, the

Vidya Mandir scheme of education in the Central Provinces, which allegedly had a Hindu cultural orientation, and various instances of alleged bias in government appointments and administration.

- The Shareef Report, formally known as the Report on the Condition of Muslims under Congress Ministries, was submitted in 1939 by a committee headed by A.K. Shareef and focused specifically on Bihar, further elaborating the Muslim League's charge that Congress ministries were systematically neglecting or suppressing Muslim interests.
- Both reports served a significant political purpose for Muhammad Ali Jinnah and the Muslim League; they were used to mobilise Muslim public opinion against the Congress, to counter the Congress's claim of being a genuinely representative all-India national organisation, and to build the narrative that Muslims could not expect fair treatment under Congress-dominated governance. Historians have debated the factual accuracy and political motivations of these reports extensively. Many Congress leaders and secular historians argued they were largely exaggerated or politically motivated documents rather than objective inquiries, but their political impact in sharpening the Congress-League divide during the critical years leading up to the Lahore Resolution of 1940 was undeniable.

Q 4. Ans. B

Explanation:

- At the Haripura Session of 1938, held in Gujarat, Subhas Chandra Bose was elected Congress President unopposed, a significant distinction from his controversial re-election the following year. The Haripura Session was notable for its grand organisation, supervised by Vallabhbhai Patel, and for the National Planning Committee being constituted under Nehru's chairmanship on Bose's initiative.

Q 5. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Wardha Resolution of September 1939, passed by the Congress Working Committee in response to Viceroy Linlithgow's unilateral declaration of India's participation in World War II, laid down that Congress could not support a war effort conducted under imperial auspices unless Britain made a clear and concrete commitment to Indian independence.
- The resolution demanded that Britain explicitly

declare that the war was being fought for democracy and self-determination, and that these principles be applied to India without ambiguity or delay.

- Congress insisted on knowing whether India would be free to frame its own constitution after the war, and sought a definitive statement of British war aims with respect to imperialism and colonial rule. When Linlithgow's October 1939 response offered only vague post-war consultations rather than any firm commitment, Congress directed its ministries to resign.

Q 6. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The August Offer explicitly reaffirmed Dominion Status as the objective for India after the conclusion of the war, along with a promise that Indians would be primarily responsible for framing the new constitutional arrangement through a post-war constituent body. However, by this stage, Congress had moved well beyond Dominion Status and was demanding complete independence, making the offer unacceptable.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The offer proposed the immediate expansion of the Viceroy's Executive Council to include a greater number of Indian representatives as a wartime political concession. However, since the expanded council would continue to function under the Viceroy's overriding authority, Congress considered this inadequate and rejected it.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The August Offer assured that the British government would not transfer power to any authority whose exercise would be opposed by large and powerful elements in India's national life, effectively granting minorities, particularly the Muslim League, a veto over future constitutional arrangements. This significantly strengthened Jinnah's bargaining position and deepened Congress's distrust of British intentions. Both Congress and the Muslim League rejected the August Offer, though for entirely different reasons.

Q 7. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Individual Satyagraha, launched by Gandhi in October 1940 after the rejection of the August Offer, was conceived as a limited and carefully controlled movement, not a mass confrontation. Its objective was to affirm the Indian people's right to freedom of speech and expression, particularly the right to

oppose India's forced participation in World War II without Indian consent.

- Gandhi deliberately avoided launching a full-scale mass movement at this stage because the international wartime situation was sensitive, and he did not wish to create a situation that would directly cripple the British war effort at that moment. Hence, selected individuals, beginning with Vinoba Bhave (the first satyagrahi) and later Jawaharlal Nehru, were chosen to publicly make anti-war statements and court arrest.

Q 8. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Vinoba Bhave was deliberately chosen by Gandhi as the first individual satyagrahi. This choice was itself politically significant, as Bhave was relatively unknown to the wider public compared to senior Congress leaders. Gandhi selected him to emphasise personal moral conviction, discipline, and selfless commitment over political stature. Bhave delivered his symbolic anti-war speech at Paunar in October 1940 and was promptly arrested, formally inaugurating the movement.
- Jawaharlal Nehru was chosen as the second satyagrahi, a decision carrying considerable political weight given his national prominence and international visibility. His arrest following his anti-war statement drew widespread attention within India and abroad, substantially amplifying the movement's political and moral message.
- Brahma Datt, a close associate of Gandhi from the Sevagram Ashram, was selected as the third satyagrahi. His inclusion reflected Gandhi's pattern of balancing nationally prominent leaders with committed constructive workers, reinforcing the movement's character as a disciplined moral protest rather than a mass political confrontation.
- The deliberate sequential and individual nature of these selections, with each person making a symbolic anti-war declaration and courting arrest before the next was nominated, was central to Gandhi's strategy of keeping the movement tightly controlled, disciplined, and morally defensible throughout its course.

Q 9. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Mahatma Gandhi delivered the famous "Do or Die" call at the All India Congress Committee session held at Gowalia Tank Maidan, Bombay, on the

night of 8 August 1942, immediately after the AICC passed the Quit India Resolution demanding an immediate end to British rule.

- His speech that night was electrifying. Gandhi called upon every Indian to consider themselves already free and to act with that spirit, declaring that this was the most decisive struggle of his political life. Through the phrase "Do or Die," he conveyed that Indians must either secure freedom through unwavering struggle or lay down their lives in the attempt, but not continue to live under colonial subjugation.
- The British response was immediate and decisive. Within hours of the resolution's passage, in the early hours of 9 August 1942, Gandhi, the entire Congress Working Committee, and virtually all top Congress leaders were arrested before any centrally coordinated movement could formally begin. This leadership vacuum, however, transformed Quit India into a spontaneous and widespread mass uprising across the country.

Q 10. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Chittu Pandey led a brief but dramatic parallel government in Ballia, in the United Provinces, in August 1942. He organised local resistance, released political prisoners from jail, and temporarily displaced British administrative authority in the district before the British reimposed control. Ballia earned the nickname "Baghi Ballia" (Rebel Ballia) for this episode.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** The parallel government established at Tamluk (Tamralipta) in the Midnapore district of Bengal was called the Jatiya Sarkar (National Government), formally proclaimed in December 1942. It functioned for nearly two years, organising relief work, running schools, maintaining law and order, and publishing its own journal -- representing one of the most sustained and administratively functional parallel governments of the movement.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** The Satara Prati Sarkar (Parallel Government) in Maharashtra, led primarily by Nana Patil, was the longest-lasting and best-organised parallel administration of the movement, functioning from 1943 to 1945. It ran its own courts, collected revenue, organised village defence, and carried out social reform activities -- serving as a remarkable example of grassroots self-governance in defiance of colonial authority.

Q 11. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Matangini Hazra, popularly known as “Gandhi Buri” (the old woman Gandhi) for her devoted adherence to Gandhian ideals, is associated with the resistance centred in Tamluk (Tamralipta) in the Midnapore district of Bengal. On 29 September 1942, she led a procession of several thousand people toward the Tamluk police station demanding the release of political prisoners and the withdrawal of British authority. When British police opened fire on the procession, Matangini continued advancing while carrying the Congress flag even after sustaining multiple gunshot wounds, until she fell fatally shot her last words reportedly being “Vande Mataram.” Her martyrdom became a powerful symbol of the resistance in Midnapore, the region that subsequently established the Jatiya Sarkar parallel government in December 1942.

Q 12. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Captain Mohan Singh, an officer of the British Indian Army captured during the Malayan campaign, played the principal role in the initial formation of the Indian National Army. After the fall of Singapore in February 1942, he began organising Indian prisoners of war into an armed force intended to fight for India’s liberation from British rule. The first INA was formally established in September 1942 under his leadership. However, tensions with the Japanese over questions of autonomy and command led to Mohan Singh’s arrest in December 1942, resulting in the collapse of the first INA.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Major Iwaichi Fujiwara of Japanese Military Intelligence played a key enabling role in the INA’s early formation. Through the Fujiwara Kikan, a Japanese intelligence unit tasked with cultivating anti-British sentiment among Indian troops, he established contact with Indian POWs and nationalist elements in Malaya. This early groundwork was instrumental in enabling Mohan Singh’s efforts.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Rash Behari Bose did not found the INA in Berlin. He had been living in exile in Japan since 1915 and was the political figure associated with the Indian Independence League in East Asia. He played a major role in the Bangkok Conference (1942), which provided

political direction to the INA. The INA emerged in Southeast Asia, particularly Singapore, not Berlin. Subhas Chandra Bose, who reached Southeast Asia in 1943, later assumed leadership and reorganised the INA into a much more effective force under the Azad Hind Government.

Q 13. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jinnah’s insistence that only the Muslim League could nominate Muslim members to the reconstituted Executive Council was the principal reason for the collapse of the Simla Conference. Accepting Muslim nominees from Congress, including nationalist Muslims, would have weakened the League’s claim that it alone represented India’s Muslim community.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Congress’s position directly conflicted with this claim. Congress maintained that it represented all Indians irrespective of religion and therefore retained the right to nominate members, including Muslims, to the Executive Council. This fundamental clash between Congress’s inclusive nationalist position and the League’s claim of exclusive Muslim representation made compromise impossible.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Simla Conference ended in failure. Lord Wavell was unable to break the deadlock over the issue of Muslim representation and suspended the conference in July 1945 without any agreement. Consequently, no interim government emerged from the Simla Conference.

Q 14. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The immediate spark for the Royal Indian Navy Mutiny (18 February 1946) occurred at HMIS Talwar, the signal training establishment in Bombay, where around 1,100 Indian ratings went on strike.
- The immediate grievances included:
 - ✓ Poor quality food and living conditions
 - ✓ Racial discrimination and abusive treatment by British officers
 - ✓ Deep resentment over broader colonial inequality and the nationalist atmosphere following the INA trials
- A particularly direct trigger was the conduct of Commander Arthur Frederick King, whose racially abusive behaviour toward Indian ratings intensified tensions.

- The strike quickly spread in Bombay itself, with ratings from HMIS Sutlej, HMIS Jumna, Castle Barracks, and Fort Barracks joining in solidarity.
- HMIS Hindustan was not part of the initial spark, as it was stationed in Karachi and joined the uprising later as the mutiny spread geographically.

Q 15. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Champaran Agrarian Committee, of which Gandhi was a member, recommended the abolition of the exploitative Tinkathia system imposed on indigo cultivators.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The committee did not recommend a complete refund of illegal recoveries. It recommended a refund of 25% of the illegal dues collected from the peasants.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Several educated middle-class leaders such as Rajendra Prasad, Gorakh Prasad and J.B. Kripalani actively supported Gandhi during the Champaran movement and worked as his close associates.

Q 16. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Cabinet Mission rejected the demand for a fully sovereign Pakistan partly on grounds of economic and administrative impracticability. It argued that partition would create serious difficulties relating to defence, communications, financial arrangements, and administrative continuity, particularly because the integrated institutional structure of British India could not be divided without substantial disruption. A truncated Pakistan, especially one deprived of economically interdependent regions, was viewed as structurally weak.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Mission also emphasised the demographic complexity of Punjab and Bengal, the two provinces central to the Pakistan demand. Both contained substantial non-Muslim populations, making any neat territorial division along communal lines extremely difficult. Partition of these provinces would itself require further partition, thereby reproducing the minority problem rather than resolving it. This formed a central element of the Mission's rejection of the Pakistan proposal.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Opposition from the British Parliament was not cited as a formal reason for rejecting Pakistan. The Cabinet Mission's

objections were framed in practical constitutional terms, focusing on administrative feasibility, economic viability, defence considerations, and demographic realities rather than parliamentary reluctance.

Q 17. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement A is correct:** Direct Action Day (16 August 1946) was called by the Muslim League after its withdrawal from the Cabinet Mission framework, primarily due to the dispute over the compulsory nature of provincial grouping and the broader constitutional deadlock with Congress. It marked the League's shift from constitutional negotiation to mass political mobilisation in pursuit of Pakistan.
- **Statement B is correct:** Direct Action Day precipitated the Great Calcutta Killings, one of the most severe episodes of communal violence in late colonial India. The violence lasted several days and caused thousands of deaths, after which communal disturbances spread to Noakhali and Bihar, intensifying communal polarisation and significantly strengthening the political momentum toward partition.
- **Statement C is correct:** H.S. Suhrawardy, the Muslim League Chief Minister of Bengal, remains controversially associated with the Calcutta violence. His administration has been criticised for administrative inaction and inadequate preventive measures, though the extent of direct political complicity remains a matter of historical debate.
- **Statement D is incorrect:** The Unionist Party in Punjab, led by Malik Khizar Hayat Tiwana, was not aligned with the Muslim League's all-India mobilisation strategy. On the contrary, Khizar's ministry resisted League pressure, and the political confrontation between the two intensified until his resignation in 1947.

Q 18. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Attlee's Declaration of 20 February 1947 announced that Britain would transfer power to "responsible Indian hands" no later than June 1948, establishing for the first time a definitive public deadline for British withdrawal from India. The declaration also announced the replacement of Lord Wavell by Lord Mountbatten as Viceroy, signalling a new political approach toward concluding the transfer of power.

- The significance of the declaration lay in its essentially unconditional character, Britain committed itself to withdrawal by the stated deadline irrespective of whether Indian political parties had reached a constitutional settlement. This transformed the negotiating environment by making indefinite delay politically impossible and placing immediate pressure on both the Congress and the Muslim League to resolve the constitutional deadlock.
- Mountbatten subsequently compressed the timetable further, advancing the transfer of power from the announced June 1948 deadline to August 1947.

Q 19. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Nizam Mir Osman Ali Khan resisted accession to India after independence, seeking either full independence or a special treaty relationship that would preserve Hyderabad's autonomous status. He signed only a Standstill Agreement with India in November 1947 to temporarily maintain existing administrative arrangements, while also exploring international avenues, including approaches concerning external recognition. From India's perspective, Hyderabad's claim to independence was strategically unacceptable given its location as a landlocked state entirely surrounded by Indian territory.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Razakars, the paramilitary wing associated with the Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen under Qasim Razvi, actively supported the Nizam's refusal to integrate with India. Their violent activities, including intimidation of the Hindu population and incursions affecting neighbouring Indian areas, significantly worsened the situation. Their actions reinforced Sardar Patel's conclusion that negotiations had failed and that military intervention had become necessary, culminating in Operation Polo in September 1948.

Q 20. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Rajendra Prasad was one of the prominent leaders who assisted Mahatma Gandhi during the Champaran Satyagraha.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** J.B. Kripalani actively participated in the Champaran movement and worked closely with Gandhi during the enquiry into peasant grievances.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Anugrah Narayan Sinha was among the important local leaders associated with the Champaran Satyagraha.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** Bipin Chandra Pal was a prominent extremist nationalist leader, but he was not directly associated with the Champaran Satyagraha.

Q 21. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Lord Mountbatten gave Gandhi the title 'One-Man Boundary Force' during the 1947 Partition riots. He observed that while a 50,000-strong military boundary force completely failed to stop the massive communal violence in Punjab, Gandhi's solitary presence, moral authority, and fasting in Bengal (specifically in Calcutta and Noakhali) successfully brought the rioting there to a halt. Mountbatten famously marvelled that what an entire army couldn't achieve in the West, one man achieved in the East.

Q 22. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Communist Party of India was formally founded within India during the Kanpur Communist Conference in December 1925.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The initial formation of the Communist Party of India took place in Tashkent in October 1920.
 - ✓ Founding members of the Tashkent group included M.N. Roy, Evelyn Roy, Abani Mukherji, Rosa Fitingof, Mohammad Ali, and Mohammad Shafiq.
 - ✓ M.N. Roy was the first Indian elected to the leadership of the Communist International (Comintern).
 - ✓ In 1924, the British government arrested S.A. Dange, Muzaffar Ahmad, Shaikat Usmani, and Nalini Gupta in the Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case.
 - ✓ The 1925 Kanpur Communist Conference was primarily organised by Satyabhakta.
 - ✓ S.V. Ghate became the first Secretary of the CPI after the 1925 Kanpur Conference.
 - ✓ In the late 1920s, communists operated openly through various provincial Workers' and Peasants' Parties.
 - ✓ The government launched a massive crackdown on communist leadership in March 1929 through the Meerut Conspiracy Case.

Q 23. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Swami Sahajanand Saraswati, the founder of the Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha, was elected as the first President.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** N.G. Ranga, a prominent agrarian leader from Andhra, was elected as the General Secretary; Indulal Yagnik was instead tasked with managing the organisation's publications.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The All India Kisan Committee officially finalised and adopted the comprehensive Kisan Manifesto during its subsequent meeting in Bombay in August 1936.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The inaugural session of the All India Kisan Sabha took place in Lucknow during April 1936.
 - ✓ This foundational conference deliberately coincided with the annual session of the Indian National Congress being held in the same city.
 - ✓ Jawaharlal Nehru personally attended the first All India Kisan Sabha conference and delivered an address to the gathered peasant leaders.
 - ✓ Indulal Yagnik officially launched and edited the organisation's primary periodical, which was titled the Kisan Bulletin.
 - ✓ The finalised Kisan Manifesto heavily influenced the official agrarian reform program adopted by the Indian National Congress at its Faizpur session.
 - ✓ The Faizpur Congress session was the first to feature a concurrent, massive All India Kisan Conference right next to the main pavilion.
 - ✓ A core objective of the Sabha was the complete abolition of the zamindari and taluqdari systems of land revenue.
 - ✓ The organisation actively demanded the immediate reduction of land revenue and rent by at least fifty percent.
 - ✓ The Sabha organised nationwide mass agitations demanding the formal abolition of begar (forced, unpaid agricultural labour).
 - ✓ Prominent regional peasant organisers like Karyanand Sharma, Yadunandan Sharma, and Rahul Sankrityayan heavily integrated their local movements into this new all-India framework.

Q 24. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The targeted murder of Doddi Komarayya, a local village militant, by the armed retainers of the Visnur

Deshmukh in July 1946 served as the immediate catalyst for the mass armed uprising.

- Makhdoom Mohiuddin, P. Sundarayya, and Ravi Narayan Reddy were prominent Communist leaders who strategically directed this movement.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The Telangana Rebellion (Telangana Movement) occurred from 1946 to 1951, making it the biggest peasant guerrilla war in modern Indian history.
 - ✓ Vetti System: Landlords (deshmukhs and jagirdars) routinely extracted an institutionalised form of unpaid, forced agricultural labour known locally as vetti.
 - ✓ Andhra Mahasabha Platform: The Communist Party of India mobilised rural masses using the regional platform of the Andhra Mahasabha.
 - ✓ Dalams (Armed Guerrilla Squads): Peasant activists organised mobile, armed guerrilla squads functioning under the designation dalams.
 - ✓ Gram Rajyams (Village Soviets): Revolutionary cadres successfully established parallel administrative structures called gram rajyams (village soviets) across approximately 3,000 villages.
 - ✓ Land Redistribution: The movement successfully confiscated and redistributed nearly 1 million acres of agricultural land to landless labourers and tenants.
 - ✓ Razakar Conflict: Guerrilla forces engaged in sustained armed combat against the Nizam's private Islamic paramilitary organisation, the Razakars, commanded by Qasim Razvi.
 - ✓ Post-Operation Polo Resistance: The rural insurgency maintained its armed posture against the state even after the Indian Army annexed Hyderabad via Operation Polo (September 1948).
 - ✓ CPI Suspension: The Communist Party leadership formally suspended the armed agrarian campaign in October 1951 to participate in the upcoming general elections.
 - ✓ Doddi Komarayya's Background: He belonged to the Kuruma (Shepherd) caste from Kadivendi village of Jangaon taluq and was the first among 4,000 communist and peasant revolutionaries killed in the Telangana People's Revolutionary Movement.
 - ✓ Statue in Moscow: A statue of Doddi Komaraiah was built in Moscow by the

Russians, recognising his significance in the international communist movement.

- ✓ Casualties: Approximately 4,000 communist and peasant revolutionaries were killed by the ruling classes, represented by the Nizam of Hyderabad.
- ✓ The Communist Party leadership formally suspended the armed agrarian campaign in October 1951 to participate in the upcoming general elections.

Q 25. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Ahmedabad Mill Workers' Strike began in 1918 after mill owners decided to withdraw the plague bonus that had earlier been granted to workers.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Gandhi advised the workers to demand a 35 per cent increase in wages instead of the originally demanded 50 per cent hike.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** During the strike, Gandhi undertook his first fast unto death to strengthen the determination of the workers and pressure the mill owners for a settlement.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** The dispute was eventually referred to a tribunal, which awarded the workers a 35 per cent wage increase.

Q 26. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jawaharlal Nehru was elected as the President at the historic Ludhiana session in 1939, signifying the mainstreaming of the states' struggles.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Haripura session (1938) explicitly maintained a policy of non-intervention by the institutional Congress; it was the subsequent Tripuri session (1939) that formally endorsed direct organisational intervention in the political agitations of the princely states.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The All India States' Peoples' Conference was originally founded in December 1927 in Bombay to politically unify fragmented regional movements.
 - ✓ Balwantrao Mehta, Maniklal Kothari, and G.R. Abhyankar served as the primary architects who organised the inaugural 1927 conference.
 - ✓ The 1938 Haripura Congress resolution explicitly prohibited local Congress committees from initiating direct political movements inside princely territories.

- ✓ Under these Haripura guidelines, activists in princely states were strictly mandated to operate through independent, localised political organisations known as Praja Mandals.
- ✓ Unprecedented mass political awakenings in states like Rajkot, Jaipur, and Travancore forced the Congress leadership to abandon this non-interventionist doctrine.
- ✓ Following the 1939 Tripuri resolution, these regional Praja Mandals were gradually integrated as active, subordinate units of the overarching Conference.
- ✓ The organisation consistently campaigned for the immediate establishment of responsible democratic governance under the constitutional aegis of the respective ruling princes.
- ✓ The British colonial administration legally classified princely states as distinct sovereign entities operating completely outside the constitutional jurisdiction of British India.
- ✓ Jawaharlal Nehru actively emphasised that the political fate of the princely states was structurally and legally inseparable from the broader Indian independence struggle.
- ✓ The organisation fiercely opposed the federal provisions of the Government of India Act 1935, which allowed princes to nominate unaccountable representatives to the federal legislature.

Q 27. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Anti-Compromise Conference of 1940 was held at Ramgarh, in present-day Jharkhand, in March 1940, significantly, at the same venue where the official Indian National Congress session was being held under the presidency of Maulana Abul Kalam Azad. Subhas Chandra Bose, who had by then resigned from the Congress presidency following the fallout of the Tripuri Session and founded the Forward Bloc in 1939, organised and presided over this parallel conference as a platform to voice uncompromising opposition to British imperialism and to challenge the moderate tendencies within the mainstream nationalist movement.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Swami Sahajananda Saraswati, the prominent kisan leader and founder of the All India Kisan Sabha, actively participated

in the Anti-Compromise Conference. His involvement reflected the broader coalition of left-leaning, radical, and agrarian forces that Bose sought to bring together under a united anti-imperialist platform. Sahajananda's participation underscored the conference's character as a gathering of those who firmly rejected any accommodation with British colonial authority during the freedom struggle.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Anti-Compromise Conference was convened to oppose and reject any compromise with British imperial authorities. The conference demanded an immediate and unconditional end to British rule and called for a united mass struggle toward complete independence. The very name of the conference, "Anti-Compromise", reflects its foundational rejection of any negotiated settlement or tactical accommodation with the colonial government.

Q 28. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Moirang, a town in present-day Manipur, holds an iconic place in the history of the Indian National Army (INA). On 14 April 1944, Colonel Shaukat Malik of the INA hoisted the flag of Azad Hind (Free India) at Moirang, marking the first time the INA's tricolour was raised on Indian soil. This was a defining moment in Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's military campaign against British rule, as the INA, advancing alongside Japanese forces, had penetrated Indian territory during the Imphal-Kohima campaign. Though the INA's advance was ultimately halted, the hoisting of the flag at Moirang remains a powerful symbol of the INA's determination to liberate India.
- **Pair 2 is incorrectly matched:** The Forward Bloc was not formed in Saigon. It was founded on 3 May 1939 in India, initially as a left-wing consolidation platform within the Congress. Saigon (present-day Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam) has no direct association with the formation of the Forward Bloc.
- **Pair 3 is incorrectly matched:** The Anti-Compromise Conference was held at Ramgarh (present-day Jharkhand) in March 1940, not Bangkok. Bangkok is associated with the broader Southeast Asian network of the Indian independence movement, particularly the Indian Independence League activities during World War II.
- **Pair 4 is incorrectly matched:** The famous INA

trials were held at the Red Fort, Delhi, beginning in November 1945, where INA officers, including Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Kumar Sahgal, and Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon, were tried for treason. Nagpur is associated with the 1940 Forward Bloc conference, where the party declared itself socialist and adopted the slogan "All Power to the Indian People," not with the INA trials.

Q 29. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Government of India Act, 1935 was the most elaborate constitutional instrument enacted for British India and envisaged a two-tier structure, an All-India Federation at the centre, linking both the British Indian provinces and the princely states, alongside provincial autonomy at the lower level. However, while the provincial autonomy provisions came into operation and elections were held in 1937, the federal scheme at the centre never came into effect, and the primary reason was the refusal of the princely states to accede to the proposed federation.
- The Act stipulated that the federation would come into existence only when princely states representing at least 50% of the total population of all states and holding 52 out of 104 seats in the proposed Council of States (upper house) had signed Instruments of Accession. The accession of princely states was made voluntary, which proved to be the fatal flaw. The princes were deeply apprehensive about surrendering their sovereignty and autonomy and they feared loss of their special privileges, interference in their internal administration, and being subjected to a legislature where elected representatives of British India would dominate. Encouraged by the Chamber of Princes and wary of growing nationalist sentiment, the princely states collectively stalled, and the required number of accessions never materialised.

Q 30. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** The Champaran Satyagraha (1917) is regarded as Gandhi's first experiment with civil disobedience in India, where he defied the government's order to leave the area.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** During the Ahmedabad Mill Workers' Strike (1918), Gandhi undertook his first fast unto death to support the workers' demand for higher wages.

- **Pair 3 is correct:** The Kheda Satyagraha (1918) is often regarded as the first Non-Cooperation movement because peasants collectively refused to pay revenue taxes to the colonial government.

Q 31. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Despite winning clear majorities in several provinces in the February 1937 elections, Congress initially refused to assume office and did not immediately form ministries. The central point of contention was the special powers and discretionary authority vested in the Governors under the Government of India Act, 1935. Congress objected particularly to Section 93, which empowered Governors to take over provincial administration, and to the broader range of the Governor's special responsibilities that allowed intervention in ministerial functioning without legislative accountability. Congress demanded assurances that Governors would not use these powers to override or obstruct elected ministries. This deadlock persisted for several months until the British government, through a clarificatory statement by the Secretary of State for India, Lord Zetland, indicated that Governors would not ordinarily interfere with day-to-day ministerial functioning. Satisfied with this assurance, though the constitutional powers themselves remained unchanged, Congress agreed to take office, and ministries were formed beginning in July 1937.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Congress ministries functioned from July 1937 until October–November 1939, a period of approximately 28 months. Their resignation was triggered by the outbreak of World War II in September 1939, when Viceroy Lord Linlithgow unilaterally declared India a belligerent nation without consulting Indian political leadership or the elected provincial legislatures. Congress demanded a clear British commitment to Indian independence as a condition for cooperation in the war effort. When no satisfactory response was forthcoming, the Congress Working Committee directed all Congress ministries to resign, which they did by November 1939, bringing the brief but significant experiment of provincial self-governance to an end.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** As established above, Congress emphatically did not immediately accept office after the election results were declared in February 1937. A gap of approximately four to five

months elapsed between the declaration of results and the actual formation of Congress ministries in July 1937, during which sustained negotiations and correspondence took place between Congress leadership and the British authorities over the Governor's special powers. This period of deliberate refusal was itself a significant political statement by Congress, demonstrating its unwillingness to function as a mere administrative instrument under a constitutional framework that it fundamentally disagreed with, unless adequate assurances of genuine responsible government were provided.

Q 32. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Congress ministries resigned in October–November 1939 primarily because Viceroy Lord Linlithgow unilaterally declared India a participant in World War II on 3 September 1939, without consulting the elected Congress ministries functioning in the provinces or the broader Indian political leadership. Congress regarded this as a grave constitutional affront, a stark demonstration that despite the exercise of provincial autonomy under the Government of India Act, 1935, India's fundamental political status remained that of a colonial dependency whose most consequential decisions, including the question of war and peace, were made entirely at British discretion without any reference to Indian representatives or popular will.
- The Congress Working Committee, meeting in September 1939, passed a resolution demanding that Britain clearly define its war aims specifically, whether the war was being fought for democracy and self-determination, and further demanded a concrete commitment to Indian independence as the price of Congress's cooperation in the war effort. When Viceroy Linlithgow's response in October 1939 proved unsatisfactory, offering only a vague promise of post-war consultations and a possible review of the 1935 Act rather than any firm commitment to independence, the Congress Working Committee directed all Congress provincial ministries to resign. By November 1939, all eight Congress ministries had tendered their resignations, bringing approximately 28 months of Congress provincial governance to an abrupt end.

Q 33. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement A is correct:** Despite the absence of

the word in the text, the resolution came to be universally known as the Pakistan Resolution due to its political implication of a separate Muslim homeland.

- **Statement B is correct:** The resolution was formally moved by A.K. Fazlul Huq, the Krishak Praja Party leader and Chief Minister of Bengal, at the Lahore Session of the Muslim League on 23 March 1940.
- **Statement C is correct:** Sir Sikandar Hayat Khan, leader of the Punjab Unionist Party, was associated with the resolution, having played a role in shaping an early draft. However, he later distanced himself from more rigid separatist interpretations, maintaining that the proposal envisaged a loose federal arrangement rather than outright partition.
- **Statement D is incorrect:** The Lahore Resolution of March 1940 notably never used the word “Pakistan” anywhere in its text. The resolution referred instead to geographically contiguous Muslim majority units in the northwestern and eastern zones of India being constituted into “independent states” with full autonomy and sovereignty. The specific term “Pakistan,” coined earlier by Choudhry Rahmat Ali in his 1933 pamphlet *Now or Never*, was entirely absent from the official language. The popular label “Pakistan Resolution” emerged later through political discourse and press usage rather than as the League’s formal terminology. Jinnah and the Muslim League initially preferred this deliberate ambiguity, as the phrase “independent states,” particularly in the plural, permitted multiple interpretations and helped consolidate wider Muslim political support.

Q 34. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Atlantic Charter (1941) was a joint declaration issued by Winston Churchill and Franklin D. Roosevelt in August 1941, affirming among other principles the right of all peoples to choose their own form of government and the restoration of self-government to those forcibly deprived of it. Indian nationalists and American opinion immediately interpreted this as applicable to India, placing Churchill in the uncomfortable position of having to explain why a charter proclaimed in the name of democracy and self-determination did not extend to Britain’s largest colony. This created significant ideological pressure and international embarrassment for Britain.
- Japanese military advances in Asia dramatically

transformed the strategic situation. Following Japan’s entry into the war after Pearl Harbour in December 1941, Japanese forces rapidly overran Malaya, Singapore, Burma, and were advancing toward the Indian border by early 1942. The fall of Singapore in February 1942, described by Churchill as the worst military disaster in British history, made Indian cooperation in the war effort a matter of urgent strategic necessity rather than a political preference. Britain needed Indian soldiers, resources, and active nationalist support, not sullen colonial acquiescence.

- Pressure from Roosevelt and Chiang Kai-shek added crucial external diplomatic weight. American President Roosevelt was genuinely committed to anti-colonialism and repeatedly pressed Churchill to resolve the Indian political deadlock, viewing Indian cooperation as essential to the Allied war effort in Asia. Chinese Nationalist leader Chiang Kai-shek visited India in early 1942 and publicly appealed to Indian leaders to support the Allied cause while simultaneously urging Britain to grant India genuine political freedom, an intervention that further embarrassed Britain internationally and reinforced American pressure on Churchill to send a credible political mission to India.

Q 35. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Kheda Satyagraha was launched in 1918 in Gujarat after a severe drought caused crop failure, and peasants demanded remission of land revenue.
- The British government refused to suspend revenue collection despite the poor agricultural conditions of the farmers.
- Mahatma Gandhi advised the peasants not to pay taxes until their demands were accepted.

Q 36. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jayaprakash Narayan made a dramatic escape from Hazaribagh Central Jail in November 1942 along with several other political prisoners. After his escape, JP became one of the most active underground leaders of the movement, coordinating resistance networks and even attempting to link the Indian struggle with Allied anti-fascist forces operating in Nepal and beyond.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Aruna Asaf Ali became one of the most celebrated figures of the Quit India Movement. She famously hoisted the Congress flag

at Gowalia Tank Maidan on 9 August 1942 after senior leaders were arrested, and subsequently went underground to organise resistance networks across the country. She was widely hailed as the “Heroine of the 1942 Movement.”

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Sucheta Kripalani actively participated in underground organisational work during the movement, working alongside other resistance leaders to sustain agitation despite the comprehensive suppression of overt political activity by British authorities.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The underground Congress Radio was operated by Usha Mehta, not Rajendra Prasad. Mehta ran clandestine broadcasts from secret locations in Bombay, keeping nationalist sentiment alive until the transmitter was eventually traced and shut down by British authorities. Rajendra Prasad had been arrested and was not associated with radio operations.

Q 37. Ans. D

Explanation:

- All three factors contributed to the Bengal Famine of 1943, which claimed an estimated 2 to 3 million lives and remains one of the gravest humanitarian disasters of colonial India.
- The scorched earth policy was implemented by British authorities in coastal Bengal to deny resources to a potentially advancing Japanese army. Under the “boat denial” and “rice denial” policies, boats were confiscated or destroyed, and rice stocks were removed from vulnerable coastal areas. This severely disrupted local transport and food distribution networks on which Bengal’s rural economy depended, creating acute shortages even before the famine fully developed.
- The diversion of food supplies for war purposes was another major structural factor. Wartime priorities required provisioning Allied military operations in the broader Southeast Asian theatre, while shipping constraints sharply limited imports. Despite repeated appeals from Indian officials, adequate relief shipments were not arranged in time, worsening the crisis.
- Hoarding and profiteering significantly intensified the famine. As supply uncertainty and panic spread, traders and merchants hoarded grain in anticipation of rising prices, reducing market availability and driving food prices beyond the reach of the rural poor, whose purchasing power had collapsed. This aligns with Amartya Sen’s analysis of the famine as

an entitlement failure, where food availability alone did not determine famine conditions; access to food was the decisive issue.

Q 38. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** The 1st Guerrilla Regiment (Subhas Brigade) was commanded by Colonel Shah Nawaz Khan, so this pairing is correct.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** The 2nd Guerrilla Regiment (Gandhi Brigade) was under Colonel Inayat Kiani, making this pair correct.
- **Pair 3 is incorrectly matched:** The Nehru Brigade was commanded by Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon, not Prem Kumar Sahgal. Sahgal held other important military responsibilities within the INA, but pairing him with the Nehru Brigade is incorrect.
- **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** Colonel Shaukat Hayat Malik commanded the Bahadur Group, the INA’s specialised commando and intelligence unit tasked with reconnaissance, infiltration, and sabotage behind enemy lines. A unit of the Bahadur Group under his leadership entered Moirang in Manipur in April 1944, where the Azad Hind flag was hoisted for the first time on Indian soil.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The INA’s 1st Division was structurally organised and placed under the direct operational command of Major General Mohammad Zaman Kiani.
 - ✓ The Subhas Brigade actively participated in the Japanese U-Go offensive, specifically engaging British colonial forces in the Chin Hills and Kohima sectors.
 - ✓ Colonel Shaukat Malik’s Bahadur Group successfully penetrated Indian territory and officially hoisted the Indian tricolor at Moirang in Manipur on April 14, 1944.
 - ✓ The Rani of Jhansi Regiment was formally raised in July 1943 in Singapore, functioning strictly as an all-female frontline combat infantry unit.
 - ✓ Captain Lakshmi Swaminathan commanded the Rani of Jhansi Regiment, with Janaki Thevar serving prominently as her second-in-command.
 - ✓ Subhas Chandra Bose officially established the Supreme Command of the INA at Singapore before relocating its forward operational headquarters to Rangoon in January 1944.
 - ✓ The British colonial administration captured INA officers Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Kumar

Sahgal, and G.S. Dhillon, subjecting them to the historic public treason trials at the Red Fort in November 1945.

- ✓ The Indian National Congress explicitly organised the INA Defence Committee, strategically utilising prominent legal stalwarts like Bhulabhai Desai, Tej Bahadur Sapru, and K.N. Katju for the defence.
- ✓ The Royal Indian Navy mutiny in February 1946 was directly catalysed by the explosive political atmosphere generated by the INA trials and the glorification of these specific brigades.

Q 39. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Desai-Liaquat Pact (January 1945), negotiated between Bhulabhai Desai, the Congress leader in the Central Legislative Assembly, and Liaquat Ali Khan of the Muslim League, proposed the formation of an interim central government with parity between Congress and the Muslim League. Under the proposal, both Congress and the League were to receive 40 percent representation each, while the remaining 20 percent would be allocated to minorities and other groups.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The pact never received formal approval from either the Congress or the Muslim League. Although the negotiations generated initial interest, both sides later distanced themselves from it. Jinnah denied that Liaquat Ali Khan had authority to conclude such an agreement on behalf of the League, while the Congress leadership, including Gandhi, did not officially endorse Desai's initiative, as it had been undertaken without formal authorisation. Consequently, the arrangement remained an unofficial political understanding that collapsed without implementation.

Q 40. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** The Kheda Satyagraha emerged as a significant peasant movement led by Mahatma Gandhi in 1918 against unjust revenue demands.
- **Reason (R) is true:** The British government ultimately agreed to suspend tax collection for the affected period, reduce revenue enhancement and return confiscated property.
- The success of these demands strengthened the movement and demonstrated the effectiveness of Gandhian satyagraha; therefore, R correctly explains A.

Q 41. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The 2nd Infantry Regiment, under Colonel Prem Kumar Sahgal, was assigned defensive responsibilities at Mount Popa during the later phase of the Burma Campaign. Sahgal, who also served as one of Bose's senior military associates, commanded the regiment during these operations.
- Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon did not command the 2nd Infantry Regiment. He was associated with the Nehru Brigade (4th Guerrilla Regiment), and during the retreat phase, surviving INA elements from different formations came into overlapping operational contact, but command of the Mount Popa defensive position rested with Sahgal.

Q 42. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Baldev Singh held the Defence portfolio.
- **Pair 2 is incorrectly matched:** Jogendra Nath Mandal held the Law portfolio, not Labour. Labour was held by Jagjivan Ram.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** C.H. Bhabha held the Works, Mines and Power portfolio.
- **Pair 4 is incorrectly matched:** Ghazanfar Ali Khan held the Health portfolio, not Communications. Communications was held by Abdur Rab Nishtar.

Q 43. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Muslim League boycotted the inaugural session of the Constituent Assembly held on 9 December 1946, refusing to participate on the grounds that the Cabinet Mission Plan's grouping scheme had not been accepted in the form the League insisted upon. This boycott meant the Constituent Assembly began its proceedings without the League's participation, significantly undermining its claim to be a fully representative body.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Sachchidananda Sinha, the oldest member of the Assembly, served as its temporary (pro tem) President during the inaugural session, in accordance with established parliamentary convention of the senior-most member presiding over initial proceedings. Dr. Rajendra Prasad was subsequently elected as the permanent President of the Constituent Assembly.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Constitution was emphatically not adopted during the inaugural

session of December 1946. The Constituent Assembly took nearly three years of deliberations to complete its work, formally adopting the Constitution of India on 26 November 1949, which came into effect on 26 January 1950.

Q 44. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Lord Louis Mountbatten was appointed as the last Viceroy of India following Attlee's Declaration of 20 February 1947, replacing Lord Wavell, who had been considered insufficiently effective in resolving the final constitutional deadlock. Mountbatten arrived in India in March 1947 and moved with notable speed, advancing the transfer of power deadline from June 1948 to August 1947.
- Mountbatten announced the Mountbatten Plan (3 June Plan) on 3 June 1947, which formally accepted partition as the basis for the transfer of power and provided for the creation of two independent dominions, India and Pakistan. The Indian Independence Act was subsequently passed by the British Parliament in July 1947, and power was transferred on 14–15 August 1947.
- Mountbatten then served as the first Governor-General of independent India until June 1948, after which he was succeeded by C. Rajagopalachari.

Q 45. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Narahari Parikh was one of the devoted Gandhians who actively participated in organising villagers during the Kheda Satyagraha.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Ravi Shankar Vyas was associated with Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel in providing leadership during the movement.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Subhas Chandra Bose was not associated with the Kheda Satyagraha of 1918.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** Mohanlal Pandya played an important role in mobilising peasants during the Kheda movement.

Q 46. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Accession to India did not immediately deprive princely rulers of all internal autonomy. The initial Instrument of Accession was deliberately limited in scope, rulers retained internal sovereignty and administrative control over their states. The full integration and merger of princely states into the Indian Union was a gradual

process that unfolded in phases after accession, with complete administrative integration and the eventual abolition of privy purses coming much later.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, as Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of States, and V.P. Menon, as Secretary of the States Ministry, were the principal architects of the integration of princely states. Through a combination of persuasion, political pressure, and, in the case of Hyderabad, military action (Operation Polo, 1948), they successfully secured the accession of nearly all 565 princely states, one of the most remarkable feats of political consolidation in modern history.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Instrument of Accession was deliberately kept narrow, covering only three subjects, Defence, External Affairs, and Communications, to make it easier for princes to sign without feeling they were surrendering complete sovereignty immediately. This strategic minimalism was central to Patel and Menon's success in securing rapid accessions.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Standstill Agreements were signed alongside the Instruments of Accession to ensure that existing administrative, commercial, and communication arrangements between the princely states and the former British Indian government continued functioning without disruption during the transition period, providing practical continuity while the larger question of full integration was worked out.

Q 47. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Sir Cyril Radcliffe had never visited India before his appointment and was selected precisely because he was considered an impartial legal figure without prior political associations in the subcontinent.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Punjab Boundary Commission and the Bengal Boundary Commission each consisted of four High Court judges, two nominated by the Congress and two by the Muslim League, with Radcliffe serving as the common chairman.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The boundary awards were deliberately withheld until after independence and were announced only on 17 August 1947, two days after the transfer of power. Mountbatten's decision to delay publication was intended to ensure that the immediate political consequences of the

award would be handled by the new governments rather than the departing British administration. This delay has been widely criticised because it denied administrators and populations prior clarity regarding territorial allocation, thereby aggravating the disorder and communal violence accompanying partition.

- **Statement 4 is correct:** The Sylhet referendum, held in July 1947, resulted in a vote in favour of joining East Pakistan, after which the Bengal Boundary process determined the final territorial demarcation relating to the district.

Q 48. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Cabinet Mission of 1946 comprised three members of the British Cabinet: Lord Pethick-Lawrence (Secretary of State for India), Sir Stafford Cripps (President of the Board of Trade), and A.V. Alexander (First Lord of the Admiralty). All three arrived in India in March 1946 to negotiate a framework for the transfer of power.
- Lord Wavell, as Viceroy of India, was present during the Cabinet Mission negotiations and played a facilitative role in the discussions, but he was not a member of the Cabinet Mission itself. His position was that of the Crown's representative in India rather than a member of the Westminster Cabinet delegation. This distinction is constitutionally significant, the Mission was explicitly a delegation of British Cabinet ministers sent to negotiate India's constitutional future, a role entirely separate from Wavell's viceregal functions. Wavell was eventually replaced by Lord Mountbatten as Viceroy in March 1947, as the British government felt a fresh political approach was needed to finalise the transfer of power.

Q 49. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Wavell Plan (June 1945), announced by Viceroy Lord Wavell in connection with the Simla Conference, proposed the reconstitution of the Viceroy's Executive Council through near-complete Indianisation. All members, except the Viceroy and the Commander-in-Chief, were to be Indians. The plan also proposed parity between caste Hindus and Muslims in the reconstituted council, while the External Affairs portfolio was to be transferred, for the first time, to an Indian member.
- The Simla Conference (June–July 1945), convened to operationalise this plan, ultimately

failed because of the unresolved issue of Muslim representation. Muhammad Ali Jinnah insisted that all Muslim members of the Executive Council must be nominated solely by the Muslim League, thereby reinforcing the League's claim that it alone represented India's Muslims. Congress rejected this, as it included Muslim members within its own fold and refused to concede the League's exclusive representative status.

- As no compromise could be reached, Wavell suspended the conference without agreement, marking another major constitutional deadlock.

Q 50. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Poona Pact increased the number of reserved seats for the Depressed Classes in provincial legislatures from 71, as proposed under the Communal Award, to 148.
- Thus, although separate electorates were abandoned, the Pact expanded political representation for the Depressed Classes within the framework of joint electorates.
- The Pact also reserved 18% of seats allotted to the general electorate in the Central Legislature for the Depressed Classes.

Q 51. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Subhas Chandra Bose made his famous "Great Escape" in January 1941 from his residence at Elgin Road, Calcutta, where he had been kept under British surveillance following imprisonment and house arrest. Disguised as "Muhammad Ziauddin," a Pathan insurance agent, he successfully evaded British intelligence and slipped out of Calcutta.
- From there, Bose travelled to Peshawar, aided by underground nationalist networks, including associates linked to the Forward Bloc. He then crossed into Afghanistan, reaching Kabul, where efforts were made to establish contact with Axis representatives. Subsequently, adopting the identity of "Orlando Mazzotta," presented as an Italian, he secured passage onward. From Kabul, he travelled through the Soviet Union and eventually reached Berlin in April 1941.
- In Germany, Bose established the Free India Centre and organised the Indian Legion from Indian prisoners of war captured by Axis forces in the North African campaign.

Q 52. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** The Govind Ballabh Pant Resolution, moved at the Tripuri Session, effectively stripped Bose of his presidential autonomy by requiring him to constitute the Working Committee in accordance with the wishes of Mahatma Gandhi. Rather than strengthening his position as the newly re-elected president, this resolution rendered Bose's authority largely ceremonial, as most senior Gandhian leaders refused to serve under him. It was a decisive organisational blow that made Bose's continued functioning as president untenable.
- **Pair 2 is incorrectly matched:** At the Tripuri Session, Subhas Chandra Bose was re-elected as Congress President after defeating Pattabhi Sitaramayya, not Jawaharlal Nehru. Nehru had previously served as Congress President at the Lucknow (1936) and Faizpur (1937) Sessions and was not a presidential candidate at Tripuri.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Following Bose's resignation from the Congress presidency in April 1939, unable to function effectively under the constraints imposed by the Pant Resolution and facing continued opposition from the Gandhian majority, Rajendra Prasad was elected as Congress President in his place. Prasad was a trusted member of Gandhi's inner circle, and his election signalled the complete restoration of Gandhian dominance within the Congress organisation following the turbulent Tripuri episode.

Q 53. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Guruvayur Satyagraha of 1931–32 was centrally associated with K. Kelappan, a prominent social reformer and Congress leader from Kerala, widely revered as the "Kerala Gandhi." The Guruvayur temple, located in the present-day Thrissur district of Kerala, was then part of the Malabar region under the Madras Presidency. Kelappan led the satyagraha demanding the right of entry for lower-caste Hindus who were traditionally excluded from the temple. When the demand was not met, he undertook a fast-unto-death at the temple premises in September 1932. Gandhi himself persuaded Kelappan to break his fast, arguing that broader social conditions were not yet ripe for the sacrifice. Though the satyagraha did not immediately succeed in opening the Guruvayur

temple, it generated widespread public debate and significantly energised the broader temple entry movement across Kerala and India.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The landmark Temple Entry Proclamation of 1936 was issued by the princely state of Travancore, under Maharaja Chithira Thirunal Balarama Varma, on 12 November 1936. This historic proclamation declared that all Hindu temples under state jurisdiction would be open to all Hindus, irrespective of caste, effectively ending centuries of institutionalised exclusion of lower castes from places of worship. It was a pioneering act, the first such state-level proclamation in India and was widely hailed by Gandhi and nationalist leaders. The proclamation was significantly influenced by sustained social reform movements in Kerala, including those led by Sree Narayana Guru and the prolonged agitations of the Ezhava and other communities.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Temple Entry Proclamation of 1936 applied exclusively to Travancore, which was an independent princely state, and did not extend to the Madras Presidency, which was directly administered British territory. The two were entirely separate jurisdictions. Temple entry in Madras Presidency was a distinct and more prolonged struggle; notably, the Madras Temple Entry Authorisation Act was passed only in 1947, enabling lower-caste Hindus to enter temples in that region. Thus, conflating the 1936 Travancore Proclamation with the Madras Presidency represents a fundamental geographical and administrative inaccuracy.

Q 54. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The colonial government deliberately shifted the trial venue from Bombay to Meerut specifically to deny the accused the legal right to a jury trial.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The British did not prevent their own nationals from being indicted; three British communists, Philip Spratt, Ben Bradley, and Lester Hutchinson, were prominently arrested and tried alongside the Indian activists.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The arrests were executed in March 1929, and the formal charge against the accused was filed under Section 121A of the Indian Penal Code.
 - ✓ The prosecution accused the leaders of conspiring to deprive the King-Emperor of the sovereignty of British India.

- ✓ Prominent Indian communist leaders arrested included S.A. Dange, Muzaffar Ahmad, P.C. Joshi, and Shaikat Usmani.
- ✓ A Central Defence Committee was formed by the Indian National Congress to fight the case legally.
- ✓ Jawaharlal Nehru, M.A. Ansari, and M.C. Chagla actively served as defence lawyers for the accused activists.
- ✓ The judicial proceedings lasted for three and a half years, becoming the most expensive trial in British India.
- ✓ The trial attracted massive international condemnation from prominent global figures, including Albert Einstein and Romain Rolland.
- ✓ In early 1933, twenty-seven accused individuals were convicted and sentenced to rigorous imprisonment or transportation.
- ✓ Muzaffar Ahmed, S.A. Dange, Joglekar, Philip Spratt, Ben Bradley, and Shaikat Usmani were among those convicted.

Q 55. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Rowlatt Act, passed in March 1919, was officially called the Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Act was based on the recommendations of the Rowlatt Commission, headed by British judge Sir Sidney Rowlatt, which investigated revolutionary and nationalist activities in India.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Act empowered the government to arrest and imprison political activists without trial and allowed secret trials without legal assistance.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** Indian leaders such as Mohammed Ali Jinnah, Madan Mohan Malaviya and Mazhar-ul-Haq opposed the Act and resigned from the Imperial Legislative Council in protest.

Q 56. 56. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Although the Muslim League ministry led by H.S. Suhrawardy introduced the Bargadars Bill to pacify the agitation, the legislation was heavily diluted and ultimately aborted due to intense political lobbying by powerful landlords.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Land Revenue Commission of Bengal, formally known as the Floud

Commission, had officially recommended in 1940 that the legal share of the harvest for sharecroppers should be increased to two-thirds.

● Additional facts:

- ✓ The Bengal Provincial Kisan Sabha officially launched the massive agrarian struggle in 1946.
- ✓ Sharecroppers, locally identified as bargadars or adhiars, customarily surrendered half of their total agricultural yield to the jotedars (landlords).
- ✓ The central rallying slogans of the agitation were “Tebhaga chai” (we want two-thirds) and “Nij khamare dhan tolo” (store the paddy in our own granaries).
- ✓ The protesting peasants systematically refused to transport the newly harvested paddy to the traditional jotedar storage facilities (khamars).
- ✓ The Dinajpur district in northern Bengal emerged as the primary epicentre of the fiercest physical confrontations.
- ✓ Prominent communist and peasant leaders, including Bhowani Sen, Sunil Sen, and Moni Singh, actively directed the regional grassroots mobilisations.
- ✓ The movement recorded massive structural participation from marginalised Rajbanshi tribal communities and impoverished Namasudra peasants.
- ✓ Peasant women independently formed organised self-defence squads known as Nari Bahinis to physically resist armed police raids and landlord retainers.
- ✓ Escalating communal violence in Noakhali and the impending geopolitical partition of Bengal severely fractured the movement’s demographic solidarity and momentum by mid-1947.

Q 57. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Narayan Meghaji Lokhande founded the Bombay Mill and Millhands’ Association in 1890, which acted as a philanthropic clearinghouse for workers’ grievances.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** B.P. Wadia established the Madras Labour Union in 1918, historically recognised as the first modern, formally organised trade union in India.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** Mahatma Gandhi founded the Ahmedabad Textile Labour Association (Majdoor

Mahajan Sabha) in 1920, following the successful implementation of his trusteeship model during the 1918 mill strike.

- **Pair 4 is incorrect:** The AITUC was founded by N.M. Joshi, Lala Lajpat Rai, and others in 1920. Jawaharlal Nehru was not the founding leader (though he presided over it much later in 1929)

- **Additional facts:**

- ✓ Sorabji Shapoorji Bengali unsuccessfully attempted to introduce a pioneering legislative bill in the Bombay Legislative Council in 1878 to formally regulate industrial working conditions.
- ✓ N.M. Lokhande launched the prominent Anglo-Marathi weekly journal Dinabandhu in 1880, specifically to highlight severe labour exploitation and organise mill workers.
- ✓ The first Indian Factory Act of 1881 primarily focused on regulating child labour, explicitly prohibiting the industrial employment of children under the age of seven.
- ✓ The subsequent Indian Factory Act of 1891 officially guaranteed a weekly holiday for all factory workers and strictly fixed working hours for women.
- ✓ The All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) was explicitly established in October 1920 to secure an organised, recognised labour representation delegation at the newly formed International Labour Organisation (ILO).
- ✓ Diwan Chaman Lall was officially appointed as the first General Secretary of the All India Trade Union Congress during its inaugural Bombay session.
- ✓ The landmark Indian Trade Union Act of 1926 formally recognised registered trade unions as legal corporate bodies, granting them specific immunities from civil and criminal prosecution.
- ✓ Moderate labour leaders, prominently including N.M. Joshi and V.V. Giri formally seceded from the AITUC during the 1929 Nagpur session to establish the independent Indian Trades Union Federation (ITUF).
- ✓ A radical communist faction further splintered from the AITUC in 1931, subsequently establishing the militant Red Trade Union Congress under the direct leadership of B.T. Ranadive and S.V. Deshpande.
- ✓ The Indian National Trade Union Congress (INTUC) was formally inaugurated in May

1947 by mainstream nationalist leaders, including Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, to counter growing communist dominance in the labour sector.

- ✓ Add that N.M. Lokhande submitted the Charter of Demands to Lord Ripon (Viceroy of India) in 1890, which included demands for an 8-hour working day, a weekly holiday, and a minimum wage.

Q 58. Ans. D

Explanation:

- U.N. Dhebar was a prominent leader in the Rajkot Prajamandal movement against excessive taxation and administrative decline in the Rajkot princely state. Sardar Patel also led the Rajkot Satyagraha (1938) with Dhebar's support.
- K.T. Bhashyam was a close associate of Gandhiji who led satyagraha in Mysore in 1939.
- Swami Ramanand Tirtha was the most prominent leader of the Hyderabad State Congress (established 1938).
- Sarangadhar Das served as General Secretary of the Orissa State People's Conference from 1937 to 1946 and was President of the Orissa and C.P. States Regional Council from 1946 to 1947.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ Swami Ramanand Tirtha: He was the President of Hyderabad State Congress and led the struggle against the Nizam's autocratic rule.
 - ✓ U.N. Dhebar: He later became President of the Indian National Congress (1955–1959).
 - ✓ Sarangadhar Das: He was elected to India's Constituent Assembly and was a Member of Parliament belonging to the Socialist Party.
 - ✓ Rajkot Satyagraha: In 1939, Gandhiji entrusted Vallabhbhai Patel to lead the satyagraha in Rajkot, marking the first time Gandhi tried his specific techniques of controlled mass struggle in a native state.

Q 59. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Introduction of Permanent Settlement was not part of the legislative record of Congress ministries (1937-39) for the straightforward reason that the Permanent Settlement had already been introduced over 140 years earlier, by Governor-General Lord Cornwallis in 1793.
- It was a revenue arrangement that permanently fixed the land revenue demand of the British

government from zamindars in Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa, effectively converting zamindars into hereditary proprietors with fixed tax obligations.

Q 60. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Swami Sahajanand Saraswati founded the Bihar Kisan Sabha to organise peasants against zamindari exploitation and agrarian injustices.
- He advocated the abolition of the zamindari system and the transfer of ownership rights to cultivators.
- Due to his dedicated service towards peasants, he became popularly known as “Kisan-Pran”.

Q 61. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The National Planning Committee (NPC) was constituted in 1938 by Subhas Chandra Bose, who was then serving as the President of the Indian National Congress, having been elected to that position at the Haripura Session of 1938. Bose's presidency was marked by a strong emphasis on industrialisation, economic planning, and modernisation as essential pillars of a future independent India. Acting on this vision, he set up the National Planning Committee and appointed Jawaharlal Nehru as its chairman. Nehru, who shared a deep intellectual commitment to planned economic development and had been significantly influenced by the Soviet model of centralised planning during his travels abroad, was a natural choice for the chairmanship.
- The NPC brought together a remarkably diverse body of participants, including industrialists, scientists, economists, engineers, provincial government representatives, and Congress leaders, reflecting the broad, technocratic ambition of the exercise. It deliberated across numerous subcommittees on subjects ranging from agriculture, industries, and power to population, social services, and women's roles in economic life. Though the NPC's work was interrupted by the resignation of Congress ministries in 1939 and the political turbulence of the World War II years, it represented the first serious, systematic attempt at comprehensive economic planning for India and laid important intellectual groundwork for the planning apparatus that independent India would eventually build, culminating in the establishment of the Planning Commission in 1950, again under Nehru's direction.

Q 62. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Harijan Sevak Sangh was established on 30 September 1932, following the signing of the Poona Pact between Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar. The Poona Pact was itself a direct outcome of Gandhi's fast-unto-death in Yerawada Jail, undertaken in protest against the Communal Award of 1932, which had granted separate electorates to depressed classes. The Harijan Sevak Sangh was conceived as an institutional mechanism to carry out practical social reform work, including opening temples, wells, schools, and public spaces to the so-called untouchables, and was led by prominent Congress leaders, including Amritlal Thakkar (Thakkar Bapa) as its secretary.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Gandhi launched the weekly journal Harijan in February 1933 as the central publication vehicle for his anti-untouchability campaign. The journal replaced his earlier publications, Young India and Navajivan, in terms of focus, and served as a platform to educate upper-caste Hindu society about the moral and social necessity of eradicating untouchability. Gandhi also undertook an extensive Harijan Tour across India in 1933–34, travelling thousands of miles to spread awareness, collect funds for the Harijan Sevak Sangh, and directly engage communities on the issue.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Following the suspension of the Civil Disobedience Movement and through the mid-to-late 1930s, Gandhi consciously and deliberately shifted his primary emphasis from active political agitation against the British toward what he called constructive work, a comprehensive programme encompassing the eradication of untouchability, promotion of khadi and village industries, basic education through the Nai Talim (Basic Education) scheme, improvement of rural sanitation, upliftment of women, and Hindu-Muslim unity. Gandhi believed that inner social transformation and self-strengthening of Indian society were prerequisites for genuine political freedom, and this phase reflected his conviction that political swaraj without social swaraj would be hollow and incomplete.

Q 63. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The foundational philosophical principle of the Wardha Scheme

was the idea of craft-centred, productive manual work as the medium of education. Gandhi proposed that all learning -- literacy, arithmetic, science, social studies, should be imparted not through conventional classroom instruction and rote memorisation, but through the activity of a productive craft such as spinning, weaving, carpentry, agriculture, or leatherwork. The child would learn academic subjects organically through engagement with the craft, making education simultaneously practical, economically productive, and intellectually stimulating. This approach was rooted in Gandhi's broader conviction that the colonial education system had created a class of Indians alienated from manual labour, their own cultural roots, and the economic realities of village life.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Following Gandhi's proposals at the All India National Education Conference held at Wardha in October 1937, a committee was constituted under the chairmanship of Dr. Zakir Hussain, the distinguished educationist who would later become the third President of India, to work out the detailed curriculum, methodology, and framework of the scheme. The Zakir Hussain Committee produced a comprehensive report that translated Gandhi's broad philosophical vision into a concrete and implementable educational curriculum, specifying the craft-centred approach for children in the age group of 7 to 14 years across a seven-year basic education programme. The committee's report became the foundational document of the scheme.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Wardha Scheme of Basic Education came to be popularly known as Nai Talim, meaning "New Education" in Hindi and Urdu. Gandhi himself used this term extensively to describe the educational philosophy underlying the scheme. Nai Talim represented not merely a pedagogical method but a comprehensive social vision, of decentralised, self-sufficient village communities whose members were educated, skilled, and economically productive. Gandhi established the Hindustani Talimi Sangh in 1938 to propagate and implement Nai Talim, and it remained a central component of his constructive programme throughout the remaining years of his life.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** Classical literary education was precisely what the Wardha Scheme sought to move away from. Gandhi was a sharp critic of

the prevailing colonial education system, which privileged English-medium instruction, literary and clerical skills, and bookish academic learning divorced from practical life. He argued that this system produced graduates fit only for clerical employment under the colonial administration, while fostering contempt for manual labour and village life. The Wardha Scheme deliberately de-emphasised classical literary education and placed productive craft work at the centre, making Statement 4 directly contradictory to the scheme's foundational purpose.

Q 64. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Subhas Chandra Bose was re-elected as Congress President at the Tripuri Session held in March 1939 at Tripuri, near Jabalpur (present-day Madhya Pradesh). He defeated Pattabhi Sitaramayya, who was the candidate backed by Mahatma Gandhi and the right-wing Gandhian faction within the Congress. Gandhi took Sitaramayya's defeat personally, remarking that it was more his defeat than Sitaramayya's. Despite winning the election, Bose faced sustained opposition from the old guard and the conservative wing of the Congress throughout the session.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Bose advocated a more assertive and confrontational approach toward British rule. He proposed that Congress issue an ultimatum demanding complete independence within six months, and that in the event of non-compliance by the British, Congress should launch a mass civil disobedience movement, what he described as a "final struggle" for freedom. This position was fundamentally at odds with the more cautious approach favoured by Gandhi and the right wing, who believed the time was not yet ripe for such a decisive step.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Pant Resolution, moved by Govind Ballabh Pant at the Tripuri Session, severely curtailed Bose's authority rather than strengthening it. The resolution required the newly re-elected president to constitute the Working Committee in accordance with the wishes of Mahatma Gandhi, effectively stripping Bose of the freedom to appoint members of his own choosing. This resolution was a decisive blow to Bose's authority and rendered his presidency largely ineffective. Unable to function independently and facing constant obstruction, Bose resigned

from the Congress presidency in April 1939 and subsequently founded the Forward Bloc.

Q 65. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Eka Movement of 1921–22 was led by Madari Pasi and was centred mainly in Hardoi, Bahraich, Sitapur and Barabanki districts of Uttar Pradesh.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The peasants protested against excessive rent demands and insisted that rent should be collected in cash rather than in kind due to high inflation.

Q 66. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Acharya Narendra Dev was formally elected as the President of the Congress Socialist Party (CSP) during its foundational conference in Bombay in October 1934.
- Jai Prakash Narayan served as the General Secretary.
- Minoo Masani and Meherally were key foundational leaders but did not hold the presidential office.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The formal foundation of the Congress Socialist Party took place in October 1934 in Bombay.
 - ✓ The conceptual origins of the party trace back to intense Marxist and socialist discussions among young Congressmen incarcerated in Nasik jail during the Civil Disobedience Movement.
 - ✓ The party operated as a cohesive ideological bloc strictly within the organisational framework of the Indian National Congress rather than forming a separate political entity.
 - ✓ The primary objective was to radicalise the mainstream Congress program and direct the national movement toward socialist structural reforms.
 - ✓ The socialists fundamentally rejected the growing parliamentary constitutionalism and council-entry programs favoured by the dominant Congress right-wing faction.
 - ✓ The party's agrarian program demanded the complete abolition of the zamindari system without providing any financial compensation to the landlords.
 - ✓ A core economic demand included the total cancellation of oppressive debts owed by impoverished peasants and agricultural labourers.

- ✓ The socialists actively advocated for the statutory recognition of both trade unions and kisan sabhas (peasant organisations) to integrate class struggles into the anti-imperialist fight.
- ✓ The party explicitly demanded the transfer of all sovereign political and economic power directly to the producing masses.

Q 67. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Karyanand Sharma led the intense agrarian agitation against local zamindars for the restoration of Bakasht lands in the Barahiya Taal area of Munger district.
- Yadunandan Sharma organised the parallel peasant movement in the Reora area of Gaya district.
- Rahul Sankrityayan led the prominent agrarian Satyagraha in the Amwari region of Saran district.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ Bakasht lands were specific agricultural plots that zamindars had confiscated from tenant farmers who defaulted on rent during the Great Depression.
 - ✓ The Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha orchestrated this massive, organised campaign for land restoration between the years 1937 and 1939.
 - ✓ Zamindars frequently deployed armed retainers and thugs to violently suppress and assault peasant activists during these systemic protests.
 - ✓ Rahul Sankrityayan suffered severe physical injuries from zamindar thugs and was subsequently sentenced to six months in prison for his role in Amwari.
 - ✓ The immense grassroots pressure forced the newly elected Congress Ministry to pass the Bihar Tenancy (Amendment) Act.
 - ✓ The provincial government was also compelled to enact the specific Bakasht Land Disputes Settlement Act of 1938 to pacify the agrarian unrest.
 - ✓ Swami Sahajanand Saraswati originally founded the Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha in 1929 specifically to mobilise peasants against zamindari abuses.
 - ✓ Karyanand Sharma eventually emerged as a prominent leader within both the Communist Party of India and the All India Kisan Sabha.

Q 68. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Lal Shankarlal was elected as the first General Secretary of the Forward Bloc, not Sarat Chandra Bose. While Sarat Chandra Bose (Subhas's elder brother) was a political and financial pillar for the Left Consolidation, Kamath was the specific architect handling the organisational machinery as General Secretary.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The Forward Bloc officially held its first All-India Conference in Nagpur between June 18 and June 22, 1940.
 - ✓ The Nagpur conference passed a definitive organisational resolution titled "All Power to the Indian People."
 - ✓ The party's Working Committee specifically organised a nationwide "National Struggle Week" from April 6 to April 13, 1940, to mobilise grassroots anti-war resistance.
 - ✓ Subhas Chandra Bose officially launched the party's dedicated English weekly mouthpiece, identically titled Forward Bloc, in August 1939 to propagate socialist editorials.
 - ✓ Prominent regional organisers included Mukundilal Sircar and B. V. A. Annapurniah, who were tasked with building the party's cadre base in Bengal and Andhra, respectively.
 - ✓ The Forward Bloc actively allied with the Muslim Students Federation to launch the militant Anti-Holwell Monument agitation in Calcutta during July 1940.
 - ✓ The British colonial administration formally declared the Forward Bloc an illegal, banned organisation in 1942 under the Defence of India Rules.
 - ✓ The party's economic manifesto explicitly called for state ownership of large-scale industries while simultaneously supporting the tactical continuation of village industries for mass rural employment.

Q 69. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Sindh was separated from the Bombay Presidency and constituted as a distinct province under the Government of India Act, 1935. Prior to this, Sindh had been administratively part of Bombay Presidency since 1847, and the demand for a separate Sindh province had been

a longstanding aspiration of Muslim political leadership in the region, as Muslims constituted a majority of its population. The separation was also endorsed by the Simon Commission report of 1930 and featured prominently in the demands placed before the Round Table Conferences. Sindh thus became one of the newly created provinces that came into existence under the 1935 Act.

- **Pair 2 is incorrectly matched:** Burma was not retained as part of British India; rather, it was formally separated from British India under the Government of India Act, 1935, and given a separate constitution and administrative framework of its own through the Government of Burma Act, 1935, enacted simultaneously. Burma had been annexed progressively and administered as a province of British India since 1886. Its separation had been debated for years, with Burmese nationalists themselves divided on the issue, some fearing separation would deprive Burma of the benefits of Indian constitutional reforms. Nevertheless, the 1935 legislation formally severed Burma's constitutional link with British India, and it became a separately administered Crown colony with effect from 1 April 1937.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Orissa was carved out as a separate province under the Government of India Act, 1935, with effect from 1 April 1936. Previously, the Oriya-speaking regions had been amalgamated within the Bihar and Orissa provinces, which had itself been separated from Bengal in 1912. The movement for a distinct Oriya-speaking province, based on linguistic and cultural identity, had been sustained for decades, and the 1935 Act finally gave it constitutional recognition. Orissa thus became one of the new provinces created by the Act, alongside Sindh, and both came into formal existence on 1 April 1936 when provincial autonomy provisions were operationalised.

Q 70. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Uttar Pradesh Kisan Sabha was established in February 1918 through the efforts of leaders such as Indra Narayan Dwivedi, Gauri Shankar Mishra and Madan Mohan Malaviya.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Baba Ramchandra emerged as a prominent peasant leader in Oudh and played a major role in strengthening the peasant movement there.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Bardoli Satyagraha of 1928 was led by Vallabhbhai Patel, not Jawaharlal Nehru. After its success, Patel received the title “Sardar” from the women of Bardoli.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** The Tebhaga Movement in Bengal demanded that sharecroppers should retain two-thirds of the produce while landlords should receive only one-third.

Q 71. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Congress rejected the August Offer primarily because it fell far short of its demand for complete independence. By 1940, Congress had long moved beyond accepting Dominion Status as a satisfactory objective. The offer’s promise of Dominion Status only after the war, combined with the limited expansion of the Executive Council under the continued overriding authority of the Viceroy, was seen as an inadequate and evasive response to India’s demand for full self-government. Congress also strongly objected to the minority veto provision, viewing it as a deliberate British mechanism to perpetuate communal divisions and obstruct meaningful constitutional progress.
- The Muslim League rejected the offer because it contained no explicit recognition of the Pakistan demand that Jinnah had formally advanced at the Lahore Session in March 1940. Although the minority veto provision broadly served the League’s strategic interests, Jinnah sought a clear British acknowledgement of the League’s claim that Muslim majority regions should have the right to separate sovereign political arrangements. The absence of such recognition made the offer unacceptable to the League.
- The simultaneous rejection by both organisations, though for entirely different reasons, illustrated the deepening political deadlock between Congress, the Muslim League, and the British colonial government, each operating from positions that had become increasingly irreconcilable and that would continue to shape the course of the independence struggle.

Q 72. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Cripps Mission refused to transfer full executive authority during the war. Churchill and the War Cabinet were firmly opposed to any dilution of executive control in wartime. When Congress

pressed for real power at the centre as a condition for cooperation, Cripps could not concede this. Gandhi captured this limitation precisely with his dismissal of the proposals as a “post-dated cheque on a failing bank”, and it became the primary reason Congress rejected the Mission.

Q 73. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Satara Prati Sarkar in Maharashtra was the longest-lasting parallel government of the Quit India Movement, functioning from 1943 to 1945. Led primarily by Nana Patil, it was also the most administratively developed, running its own courts (Nyayadan Mandals), revenue collection, village defence squads (Toofan Senas), and social reform programmes including suppression of the liquor trade.
- Ballia under Chittu Pandey lasted only a few days in August 1942 before British forces reimposed control, the most short-lived of all parallel governments despite its dramatic impact.
- Tamuk’s Jatiya Sarkar in Bengal, proclaimed in December 1942, was sustained and functional but shorter in duration than Satara.

Q 74. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Indian Independence League (IIL) in East Asia was initially led by Rash Behari Bose, the veteran revolutionary who had lived in exile in Japan since 1915 after escaping British pursuit following revolutionary activities in India. Over the decades, he developed strong political and social connections in Japan, which made him the most credible senior Indian nationalist figure in East Asia.
- He presided over the Bangkok Conference of June 1942, where the IIL was formally organised as the political umbrella body for coordinating the Indian independence movement in Southeast Asia, alongside the military efforts that were taking shape through the Indian National Army under Mohan Singh.
- Recognising that the movement required a leader with far greater mass appeal and contemporary political stature across India, Rash Behari Bose facilitated the transfer of leadership to Subhas Chandra Bose after his arrival in Southeast Asia in 1943. At the Singapore Conference in July 1943, Rash Behari Bose formally handed over leadership of the IIL to Subhas Chandra Bose. Thereafter,

Subhas assumed command of the INA, revitalised the movement, and went on to establish the Provisional Government of Azad Hind in October 1943.

Q 75. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Assertion (A) is true: Vallabhbhai Patel became widely known as “Sardar” after the success of the Bardoli Satyagraha in 1928.
- Reason (R) is true: The women of Bardoli conferred the title “Sardar” upon Patel in recognition of his leadership during the peasant struggle. Therefore, R correctly explains A.

Q 76. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Provisional Government of Azad Hind (Free India) was formally proclaimed on 21 October 1943 in Singapore by Subhas Chandra Bose, who assumed the roles of Head of State, Prime Minister, and Minister for War and Foreign Affairs. Revered as “Netaji,” Bose sought to present Azad Hind as the legitimate sovereign government of an independent India in exile.
- The government established the institutional framework of a functioning state, including a cabinet, judicial arrangements, civil administrative structure, and its own currency framework, while exercising authority through the Indian National Army (INA) as its armed wing.
- Azad Hind received diplomatic recognition from several Axis-aligned states, including Germany, Japan, Italy, Croatia, Burma, the Philippines, and Manchukuo, lending it international symbolic legitimacy within the wartime geopolitical context. Its creation marked the most serious attempt by Indian nationalists to establish an alternative sovereign authority outside British control through armed struggle.

Q 77. Ans. B

Explanation:

- When Japan transferred administrative control of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands to the Provisional Government of Azad Hind in November 1943, Subhas Chandra Bose renamed them “Shaheed Dweep” (Martyr Islands) and “Swaraj Dweep” (Self-rule Islands) respectively. Bose personally visited the islands in December 1943 and hoisted the flag of Azad Hind, a moment of immense symbolic

significance as it represented the Azad Hind Government exercising actual territorial sovereignty over Indian soil, however limited in extent.

Q 78. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Junagadh presented a unique and provocative challenge to the integration process. The Nawab of Junagadh, Mahabat Khan, acceded to Pakistan in August 1947 despite the state being geographically located in the Kathiawar peninsula of western India, sharing no territorial contiguity with Pakistan, and having an overwhelmingly Hindu-majority population of approximately 80%.
- Pakistan’s acceptance of this accession was constitutionally significant and politically problematic from India’s perspective, as it directly contradicted the principle the Muslim League had invoked to justify Pakistan’s creation, namely, that Muslim-majority areas should form Pakistan. If the personal decision of a Muslim ruler could determine accession irrespective of geography and demographic composition, it would weaken India’s position regarding other princely states, particularly Hyderabad and Kashmir.
- India refused to recognise the accession, imposed economic pressure, and supported political opposition within the state. The Nawab eventually fled to Pakistan, after which Indian forces entered Junagadh. A plebiscite held in February 1948 overwhelmingly favoured accession to India, bringing the issue to a formal conclusion in India’s favour.

Q 79. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Mountbatten’s visit to Hari Singh occurred in June 1947, before independence, when Mountbatten travelled to Srinagar to personally persuade Hari Singh to decide on accession before the transfer of power. Hari Singh avoided a direct meeting, feigning illness, and refused to commit to either dominion.
- The tribal invasion backed by Pakistan began on 22 October 1947, when Pakistani-backed Pashtun lashkars crossed into Kashmir and advanced rapidly toward Srinagar, forcing Hari Singh’s hand.
- The Instrument of Accession was signed on 26 October 1947, after Hari Singh’s desperate appeal to India and V.P. Menon’s rushed visit to Srinagar to secure the formal accession document, enabling Indian troops to be airlifted the following day.

Q 80. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- Baba Ramchandra emerged as an important peasant leader in the Oudh peasant movement.
- Vallabhbhai Patel led the Bardoli Satyagraha of 1928 against enhanced land revenue demands.
- Swami Sahajanand Saraswati founded the Bihar Kisan Sabha to fight for peasant rights and the abolition of zamindari.
- Madari Pasi led the Eka Movement of 1921–22 in parts of Uttar Pradesh.

Q 81. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- While the rest of the country was celebrating independence and Jawaharlal Nehru was delivering his “Tryst with Destiny” speech in New Delhi on August 15, 1947, Mahatma Gandhi chose not to participate in the festivities. He was stationed in a dilapidated house in Beliaghata, Calcutta, fasting and holding prayer meetings to quell the severe communal riots that had erupted between Hindus and Muslims in the wake of Partition.

Q 82. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Malati Choudhury was a central architect of the Utkal Provincial Kisan Sabha, tirelessly organising massive peasant awakenings against severe zamindari exploitation across the Odisha region.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The Utkal Provincial Kisan Sabha was formally established in 1935 to systematically combat the oppressive land revenue structures prevalent throughout coastal Odisha.
 - ✓ Co-founders: Malati Choudhury, Gopabandhu Choudhury, and Nabakrushna Choudhury collaborated to build a robust socialist and agrarian political foundation within the province.
 - ✓ Leadership: H.K. Mahatab was elected as the President, and Malati Choudhury as the Secretary of the Utkal Kisan Sangha
 - ✓ First Conference: The first Utkal Kisan Conference was held at Cuttack Town Hall on 10 June 1935, under the Presidentship of Mohanlal Gautam of Uttar Pradesh.
 - ✓ Orissa Tenancy Act Amendment: The Sabha fiercely demanded immediate legislative amendment of the restrictive Orissa Tenancy

Act to secure permanent, legal occupancy rights for actual cultivators.

- ✓ Abolition of Begar: The movement explicitly campaigned for the complete abolition of illegal feudal levies and forced labour (begar) exacted by landlords from the peasantry.
- ✓ Praja Mandal Collaboration: The regional peasant awakening deeply intersected with parallel Praja Mandal agitations demanding democratic rights within neighbouring Odia princely states.
- ✓ Vernacular Literature: Organisers actively printed and distributed radical agrarian literature translated into the vernacular Odia language to raise grassroots political consciousness.
- ✓ Political Context: The destiny of Odisha’s peasants was guided by Congress Socialists, who played a central role in the Kisan movement.
- ✓ Mass Mobilisation: Activists organised massive, disciplined peasant marches and public rallies to physically demonstrate severe agrarian discontent against entrenched local zamindars.
- ✓ Rent Reduction Demand: The movement demanded immediate reduction of land revenue and rent to alleviate peasant distress.

Q 83. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- The Punnapra-Vayalar Uprising was a specific armed communist rebellion directed against the autocratic administration of the Travancore princely state.
- Karivellur, Kayyur, and Morazha struggles were all prominent communist-led agrarian uprisings located strictly within the directly British-administered Malabar district.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The formal general strike that precipitated the most violent confrontations was officially launched on October 22, 1946.
 - ✓ The uprising was directed against the oppressive rule of C.P. Ramaswami Iyer, the Diwan of Travancore
 - ✓ The revolt is named after the two places in Alappuzha district where it took place: beginning in Punnapra and ending in Vayalar.
 - ✓ Kayyur Incident (1941): The Kayyur agitation famously culminated in the execution of four young communist peasants by the British colonial judiciary.

- ✓ Karivellur and Kavumbayi Struggles: These concurrent struggles in neighbouring Malabar specifically focused on violently preventing powerful landlords from exporting hoarded paddy during the famine period.
- ✓ The revolt weakened the authority of the Diwan.
- ✓ The Maharajah agreed to accede the kingdom to the Indian Union a week after the assassination attempt.
- ✓ Pattom Thanu Pillai became the first Chief Minister of Travancore-Cochin (1948) after Travancore's integration.

Q 84. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Nagpur Conference of the All India Forward Bloc, held in 1940, was a landmark organisational milestone in which the Forward Bloc formally declared itself a socialist party. It adopted a clearly left-wing ideological orientation, positioning itself as a radical alternative to what Bose and his supporters perceived as the overly moderate and compromising tendencies within the mainstream Indian National Congress. This declaration gave the Forward Bloc a distinct ideological identity, differentiating it both from the Gandhian Congress right and from other existing socialist formations within the broader nationalist movement.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Nagpur Conference adopted the powerful slogan "All Power to the Indian People", which encapsulated the Forward Bloc's core ideological demand, the complete transfer of political, economic, and social authority from British colonial hands to the Indian people themselves. This slogan reflected the party's rejection of dominion status or any partial transfer of power and its insistence on full, unconditional independence accompanied by a fundamental restructuring of political power in favour of the masses, particularly workers and peasants.

Q 85. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Option C is correct:** Brigadier-General Reginald Dyer ordered troops to open fire on the unarmed gathering at Jallianwala Bagh, Amritsar, on 13 April 1919 without any warning. The massacre became one of the most tragic incidents of British rule in India.

- **Option A is incorrect:** Michael O'Dwyer was the Lieutenant-Governor of Punjab at the time of the massacre. He supported Dyer's actions and the repressive measures taken in Punjab, but he did not personally order the firing at Jallianwala Bagh. Later, Udham Singh assassinated Michael O'Dwyer in 1940 in revenge for the massacre.
- **Option B is incorrect:** Lord Chelmsford was the Viceroy of India from 1916 to 1921. Although he was the head of the British administration in India during the incident, he was not the officer who directly ordered the firing.
- **Option D is incorrect:** Sir Sidney Rowlatt was the British judge who headed the Rowlatt Commission. The commission's recommendations led to the passage of the repressive Rowlatt Act (1919), but he had no direct role in the Jallianwala Bagh firing.

Q 86. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Historian A.J.P Taylor described the Jallianwala Bagh massacre of 1919 as the "decisive moment when Indians were alienated from British rule."
- The massacre occurred on 13 April 1919 at Amritsar when Brigadier-General Reginald Dyer ordered troops to fire on an unarmed gathering without warning.
- The incident deeply shocked Indian public opinion and destroyed the faith of many Indians in the fairness of British rule.
- The tragedy became a turning point in the Indian national movement and strengthened the demand for complete independence from British rule.

Q 87. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Disorders Inquiry Committee, popularly known as the Hunter Committee or Hunter Commission, was constituted to investigate the disturbances in Punjab, Bombay and Delhi, including the events related to the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The committee was formed on the orders of Edwin Montagu, the Secretary of State for India, after widespread criticism of British actions in Punjab.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The committee was headed by Lord William Hunter, not Sir Sidney Rowlatt. Sidney Rowlatt had earlier chaired the Rowlatt Commission, whose recommendations led to the Rowlatt Act of 1919.

Q 88. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Government of India Act, 1935, abolished dyarchy at the provincial level, which had originally been introduced by the Government of India Act, 1919, under the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms. Under the 1919 framework, provincial subjects were bifurcated into “reserved” subjects, administered by the Governor and his executive council without legislative accountability and “transferred” subjects, administered by ministers responsible to the elected legislature. This division created an awkward and often dysfunctional dual system of governance at the provincial level. The 1935 Act swept away this division entirely and introduced full responsible government in the provinces, wherein all provincial subjects were placed under ministers collectively responsible to the elected provincial legislature. Governors retained certain special powers and discretionary functions, but the substantive governance of provinces was made accountable to elected representatives. Notably, while dyarchy was abolished in the provinces, the 1935 Act paradoxically introduced dyarchy at the Centre, though, as discussed separately, this central federal scheme never came into operation.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Bicameral legislatures, consisting of a Legislative Assembly (lower house) and a Legislative Council (upper house), were not introduced in all eleven British Indian provinces. The 1935 Act established bicameral legislatures only in six provinces: Madras, Bombay, Bengal, the United Provinces, Bihar, and Assam. The remaining five provinces, Punjab, the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP), the Central Provinces, Orissa, and Sind, retained unicameral legislatures consisting of a single Legislative Assembly. The decision to establish bicameral or unicameral structures was calibrated according to the administrative size, population, and political complexity of each province, making it incorrect to generalise that all provinces received bicameral legislatures under the Act.

Q 89. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Mahatma Gandhi was not associated with the observance of the Day of Deliverance. On the contrary, the Day of Deliverance was fundamentally

directed against the Congress and its provincial ministries, the very political organisation Gandhi led and whose record of governance he had championed. Gandhi defended the Congress ministries’ performance in office and rejected the characterisation that they had suppressed or discriminated against minorities and marginalised communities. His association with this observance would have been entirely self-contradictory.

- The Day of Deliverance was observed on 22 December 1939, called by Muhammad Ali Jinnah and the All India Muslim League to celebrate what they described as liberation from the alleged tyranny and Hindu domination of Congress provincial ministries following their resignation in October and November 1939. The occasion brought together a politically diverse coalition united primarily by their opposition to or disillusionment with Congress’s governance.
- Muhammad Ali Jinnah was the principal architect of the Day of Deliverance, using it as a powerful political instrument to consolidate Muslim opinion against Congress and to advance the League’s claim that it, not Congress, was the sole legitimate representative of Indian Muslims. B.R. Ambedkar participated and expressed solidarity with the observance, consistent with his longstanding criticism of Congress for what he perceived as its failure to genuinely address Dalit rights and its tendency to subsume Dalit political interests within a broader nationalist framework that remained dominated by upper caste leadership. E.V. Ramasamy Periyar, the radical social reformer and founder of the Self-Respect Movement in South India, also associated himself with the occasion, reflecting his deep hostility toward Congress, which he viewed as an instrument of Brahminical and upper caste dominance over the non Brahmin and Dravidian populations of the south.

Q 90. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Rowlatt Act was passed in March 1919 during the Viceroyalty of Lord Chelmsford (1916–1921).
 - ✓ The Act was officially known as the Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act and was based on the recommendations of the Rowlatt Commission headed by Sir Sidney Rowlatt.
 - ✓ It empowered the British government to detain individuals without trial, impose restrictions on freedom of speech and assembly, and conduct secret trials.

- ✓ The Act was widely opposed across India and led to the launch of the Rowlatt Satyagraha under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi.
- **Option A is incorrect:** Lord Curzon served as Viceroy from 1899 to 1905 and is mainly associated with the Partition of Bengal in 1905.
- **Option C is incorrect:** Lord Irwin served as Viceroy from 1926 to 1931 and is associated with the Gandhi-Irwin Pact and the Civil Disobedience Movement.
- **Option D is incorrect:** Lord Wavell served as Viceroy from 1943 to 1947 and is known for the Wavell Plan and the Simla Conference of 1945.

Q 91. Ans. A

Explanation:

- After the First World War, Indians expected constitutional concessions from the British government in return for India's support during the war. However, instead of reforms satisfying Indian aspirations, several developments generated widespread resentment.
- Economic hardship increased due to inflation, rising taxation, unemployment and a decline in industrial production.
- The brutal suppression in Punjab, particularly the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, exposed the repressive nature of colonial rule.
- The Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms introduced dyarchy, but Indians found it inadequate and deceptive because real powers remained with the British.
- Permanent Settlement was introduced in 1793 and was unrelated to post-war developments. Hence, statements 1, 2 and 3 are correct.

Q 92. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** At the Tripuri Session of 1939, held near Jabalpur in present-day Madhya Pradesh, Subhas Chandra Bose defeated Pattabhi Sitaramayya in the Congress presidential election. Sitaramayya was the candidate backed by Mahatma Gandhi and the Gandhian right wing of the Congress. Bose, who sought re-election on a platform of uncompromising anti-imperialism and a more confrontational approach toward the British, secured a clear majority despite sustained opposition from the old guard. The margin of victory, while not overwhelming, was politically decisive and represented a significant, if short-lived,

assertion of the radical left against the dominant Gandhian faction.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Gandhi responded to Sitaramayya's defeat with politically charged remark that Pattabhi's defeat was more his own defeat than Pattabhi's. This statement was deeply significant, as it transformed what had been an organisational election into a direct referendum on Gandhi's authority within the Congress, and effectively signalled to the broader Congress membership where their loyalties were expected to lie. The remark galvanised the Gandhian majority within the Congress Working Committee, most of whose members declined to serve under Bose, precipitating the crisis that ultimately led to the Pant Resolution, Bose's effective marginalisation, his resignation from the presidency in April 1939, and his subsequent founding of the Forward Bloc.

Q 93. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The secession clause in the Cripps Proposals stipulated that provinces unwilling to join the proposed post-war Indian Union could choose not to participate in the new constitutional framework and instead negotiate separate arrangements with Britain. Its primary significance lay in providing, for the first time, an explicit constitutional opening for the territorial disintegration of India, by acknowledging that not all parts of British India were required to remain within a single future union.
- Congress strongly opposed this provision because it appeared to grant constitutional legitimacy to the logic underlying the Muslim League's Pakistan demand after the Lahore Resolution of 1940. By recognising provincial non-participation as a formal constitutional option rather than merely a political claim, the clause substantially strengthened the League's negotiating leverage and made the prospect of partition constitutionally conceivable. This marked a major shift in the constitutional discourse surrounding India's future.

Q 94. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Operation Zero Hour was the codename for the British government's pre-emptive crackdown carried out in the early hours of 9 August 1942, just hours after the All India Congress Committee passed the Quit India Resolution at Gowalia Tank Maidan, Bombay, on the night of 8 August.

- In a swift and coordinated operation, Gandhi, the entire Congress Working Committee, and virtually all major Congress leaders across the country were arrested simultaneously before they could organise or direct the movement. Gandhi was detained at the Aga Khan Palace, Pune, where he remained imprisoned until 1944.
- The British strategy was clear: by removing the entire national leadership at the very outset, they intended to prevent the emergence of a centrally coordinated mass uprising. However, the strategy achieved only limited success. Instead of suppressing resistance entirely, the arrests triggered a spontaneous and leaderless rebellion across several parts of India, especially Bihar, eastern United Provinces, Maharashtra, and Bengal. Protesters attacked railway lines, telegraph offices, police stations, and other symbols of colonial authority, while in some regions parallel governments emerged, most notably at Satara in Maharashtra and Tamluk in Bengal.

Q 95. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Quit India Movement (August 1942 onwards) unfolded in three broad, overlapping phases following the mass arrest of Congress leadership under Operation Zero Hour.
- Urban strikes and demonstrations came first, erupting immediately after the arrests of 9 August 1942. Students, workers, and urban populations responded with hartals, processions, and strikes across major cities including Bombay, Ahmedabad, and Calcutta. This phase was spontaneous and emotionally charged, driven largely by outrage at the wholesale arrest of the national leadership.
- Rural rebellion and attacks on communication lines followed as the movement spread beyond cities into the countryside, particularly in Bihar, eastern United Provinces, Bengal, and Maharashtra. Peasants and rural populations attacked police stations, cut telegraph wires, uprooted railway lines, and targeted other symbols of British administrative authority. This phase was significantly more intense and difficult to suppress than the urban agitation, and the British response included aerial strafing of villages in some areas.
- Underground resistance and parallel governments represented the final and most organised phase, emerging as overt agitation was suppressed by British force. Underground networks sustained

the movement through pamphlets, courier systems, and the famous Congress Radio operated by Usha Mehta. In certain areas, notably Satara in Maharashtra under Nana Patil and Tamluk (Tamralipta) in Bengal, genuine parallel administrations were established that functioned independently of British authority for extended periods, representing the movement's most radical political expression.

Q 96. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The C. Rajagopalachari Formula (CR Formula) of 1944 was historically significant because it marked the first serious attempt by a senior Congress leader to acknowledge, albeit conditionally, the possibility of partition as a negotiable political outcome rather than rejecting it outright. Rajagopalachari proposed it as a pragmatic effort to break the deadlock between the Congress and the Muslim League and to secure League cooperation in the struggle for independence.
- Its principal provisions were that the Muslim League would support the Congress demand for immediate independence and cooperate in the formation of an interim government. After the war, a commission would demarcate contiguous districts in the northwest and northeast where Muslims formed an absolute majority, following which a plebiscite of all residents in those areas would determine whether they wished to form a separate sovereign state. If partition were approved, agreements would be negotiated regarding defence, commerce, and communications. Importantly, separation was to occur only after independence, not before.
- Jinnah rejected the proposal, describing it as a "mutilated and moth-eaten Pakistan." His objections included the fact that the plebiscite would involve all residents rather than only Muslims, that partition would be considered only after independence, and that continued common arrangements would dilute full sovereignty.

Q 97. Ans: C

Explanation:

- The Khilafat issue became an important basis for Hindu-Muslim unity because the Indian National Congress supported Muslim concerns regarding the position of the Khalifa of Turkey. Leaders like Mahatma Gandhi saw this as an opportunity to unite Indians against British imperialism.

- However, the reason statement is incorrect because Congress leaders opposed British policy towards Turkey. They criticised Britain for dismembering Turkey and removing the authority of the Khalifa after the First World War.
- Thus, the assertion is true, but Reason is false.

Q 98. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Gandhi-Jinnah Talks of September 1944, held in Bombay, were a significant but ultimately unsuccessful attempt to bridge the widening political divide between the Indian National Congress and the All India Muslim League. Gandhi, recently released after detention following the Quit India Movement, initiated the discussions using the C. Rajagopalachari Formula (CR Formula) as the basis for negotiation.
- The talks failed primarily because of a fundamental disagreement over the timing, terms, and principle of partition. Gandhi's position, consistent with the CR Formula, was that India should first achieve independence as a united entity, after which Muslim-majority areas could decide through a plebiscite whether they wished to separate. He also maintained that such a plebiscite should involve all residents of the concerned areas, not Muslims alone.
- Jinnah rejected this framework outright. He insisted that the principle of Pakistan be accepted in advance and unconditionally, not treated as a contingent post-independence possibility. His argument rested on the two-nation theory, which held that Hindus and Muslims were distinct political nations entitled to separate statehood. Gandhi refused to accept this premise, viewing it as fundamentally incompatible with the idea of a composite Indian nationhood.
- Jinnah also objected to specific aspects of the CR Formula, including the inclusion of all residents in the plebiscite rather than only Muslims, and the proposal for shared arrangements in areas such as defence and communications, which he believed would undermine the sovereignty of a future Pakistan.
- After fourteen rounds of discussion, the talks collapsed, with neither side willing to concede on their foundational political positions.

Q 99. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The INA Defence Committee, constituted by the Congress to defend the accused officers in the

Red Fort Trials (1945–46), included prominent legal and political figures such as Bhulabhai Desai as lead counsel, Tej Bahadur Sapru, Kailash Nath Katju, Asaf Ali, and Jawaharlal Nehru, who notably resumed his legal robes for the defence. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel was not a member of this defence team.

- While Patel supported the political demand for clemency and recognised the enormous nationalist sentiment generated by the INA trials, he was comparatively less emotionally identified with the INA's military strategy than leaders such as Nehru. His support was political rather than participatory in the legal proceedings.

Q 100. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Lucknow Pact was signed in 1916 between the Indian National Congress and the Muslim League, marking an important phase of Hindu-Muslim unity.
- Rowlatt Satyagraha was launched on April 6, 1919, against the repressive Rowlatt Act, which allowed detention without trial.
- The Jallianwala Bagh massacre took place on 13 April 1919 at Amritsar, when General Dyer ordered firing on a peaceful gathering.
- The Khilafat Committee was formed in March 1919 under leaders like the Ali Brothers, Maulana Azad and Hakim Ajmal Khan to protest British policy towards Turkey after the First World War.

Q 101. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Annie Besant and Bipin Chandra Pal opposed Gandhi's extra-constitutional mass agitation and preferred constitutional methods.
- C.R. Das remained within Congress.

Q 102. Ans. C

Explanation:

- At the Nagpur Session of the Indian National Congress, Congress adopted a major ideological change:
 - ✓ Earlier objective: self-government through constitutional means,
 - ✓ New objective: attainment of swaraj through peaceful and legitimate mass struggle.
- This marked the beginning of Gandhian mass politics in India.

Q 103. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny ended after intervention by mainstream political leadership, most notably Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel from the Congress and Muhammad Ali Jinnah from the Muslim League, both of whom appealed to the ratings to surrender.
- A crucial meeting took place between Sardar Patel and M.S. Khan, the President of the Naval Central Strike Committee, following which the ratings agreed to lay down arms. Patel assured them that their grievances would be taken up politically, though the expectation that no punitive action would follow was not fully realised.
- Both the Congress and the Muslim League were unwilling to endorse an armed military uprising at a delicate moment when constitutional negotiations over the transfer of power were underway. Their strategic priority was controlled political transition, not spontaneous armed confrontation.

Q 104. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In the 1945–46 elections, Congress achieved overwhelming success in the general (non-Muslim) constituencies, emerging as the dominant political force in most provinces and subsequently forming ministries in eight provinces. Its strong performance in the Central Legislative Assembly elections further reinforced its claim to represent the broader nationalist constituency.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Muslim League achieved a dramatic electoral breakthrough, winning all 30 Muslim seats in the Central Legislative Assembly and an overwhelming majority of Muslim-reserved seats in the provincial elections (around 75 percent or more). This marked a decisive shift from its weak showing in 1937 and firmly established Jinnah's claim that the League was the principal political representative of India's Muslims.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Non-League Muslim political formations suffered major defeats. Congress-backed nationalist Muslim candidates, the Jamiat Ulema-i-Hind, the Unionist Party in Punjab, and the Krishak Praja Party in Bengal lost substantial ground to the Muslim League. The decline of the Unionist Party in Punjab was especially consequential, as it removed one of the last major alternative Muslim political centres outside League control.

Q 105. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Treaty of Sèvres imposed severe conditions on Turkey after the First World War: Turkey was dismembered, Ottoman authority was weakened, and the position of the Khalifa was threatened.
- Since Indian Muslims regarded the Turkish Sultan as their spiritual leader, this created widespread resentment and strengthened the Khilafat Movement.

Q 106. Ans. C

Explanation:

- In June 1920, the Khilafat Committee held an important conference at Allahabad. During this conference:
 - ✓ Mahatma Gandhi suggested adopting a programme of non-violent non-cooperation against British rule.
 - ✓ The Khilafat leaders unanimously accepted Gandhi's proposal.
- Gandhi was requested to lead the proposed Non-Cooperation Movement.
- This event became a turning point because it linked the Khilafat issue of Muslims with the broader Indian nationalist struggle against British rule.
- Later, in September 1920, the Special Session of the Indian National Congress at Calcutta, under the presidentship of Lala Lajpat Rai, officially approved the Non-Cooperation Movement.

Q 107. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The INA trials and the post-war military mutinies, particularly the Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of February 1946, followed by sympathetic unrest in the Royal Indian Air Force and sections of the army, significantly undermined the institutional foundation of British rule in India: the presumed loyalty of the Indian armed forces.
- The INA trials produced an outcome directly contrary to British expectations. Instead of discrediting INA personnel as traitors and collaborators, the trials transformed Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Kumar Sahgal, and Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon into nationally revered symbols of anti-colonial resistance. The public response was marked by an unprecedented degree of political mobilisation cutting across communal, regional, and class divisions, indicating that nationalist

sentiment had expanded far beyond conventional Congress-led agitation.

- The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny carried this development into a far more serious strategic domain by demonstrating that nationalist disaffection had penetrated the armed forces themselves. This was of profound significance because British control over India rested not merely on administrative legitimacy, but on the operational reliability of Indian military personnel serving under colonial command.
- The post-war context intensified the seriousness of this development. Britain emerged from the Second World War economically weakened, militarily overstretched, and politically constrained under a Labour government less inclined toward prolonged imperial coercion. Under such conditions, any erosion in the dependability of Indian armed forces materially altered the feasibility of continued colonial rule.
- For this reason, historians frequently identify the INA episode and subsequent military unrest as critical accelerants in the British decision to transfer power, as they raised fundamental doubts about the practical enforceability of imperial authority in India.

Q 108. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Cabinet Mission of 1946, sent by the British Labour government under Clement Attlee, was primarily tasked with securing an orderly transfer of power to Indian hands while evolving a constitutional framework acceptable to the principal political stakeholders, especially the Indian National Congress and the All India Muslim League. Britain's post-war economic exhaustion, changing political circumstances, and the growing instability within India made the continuation of direct colonial rule increasingly untenable. The Mission therefore sought a negotiated constitutional settlement that could preserve Indian unity while addressing Muslim political concerns.
- The Mission's constitutional proposals, announced in May 1946, rejected the Muslim League's demand for a fully sovereign Pakistan on practical and administrative grounds, particularly because partition would create serious problems relating to defence, communications, and the distribution of mixed populations. Instead, it proposed a three-tier constitutional structure:

- ✓ a Union of India dealing only with defence, foreign affairs, and communications;
 - ✓ provincial groupings, namely:
 - Group A: Hindu-majority provinces
 - Group B: Muslim-majority northwestern provinces
 - Group C: Bengal and Assam
 - ✓ individual provinces, which would retain all residuary powers
- The Mission also proposed the formation of a Constituent Assembly to frame the future constitution on this basis, along with an Interim Government to administer India during the transitional phase pending transfer of power.

Q 109. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Surendranath Banerjee founded the Indian National Liberal Federation after distancing himself from Gandhi's Non-Cooperation strategy.
- The Liberals believed in constitutional reforms, gradual political progress, and cooperation with the British government rather than mass agitation.

Q 110. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Several prominent lawyers boycotted British courts during the movement, including Motilal Nehru, Chittaranjan Das, Vallabhbhai Patel, Rajendra Prasad and others.
- Tej Bahadur Sapru did not join the Non-Cooperation boycott movement and remained associated with constitutional politics. Hence, option B is correct.

Q 111. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The grouping scheme of the Cabinet Mission Plan became the principal constitutional point of conflict between the Congress and the Muslim League, and was a major factor in the eventual collapse of the Plan.
- Under the Mission's proposal, provinces were to be organised into three groups:
 - ✓ Group A: Madras, Bombay, United Provinces, Bihar, Central Provinces, and Orissa
 - ✓ Group B: Punjab, Sindh, NWFP, and Baluchistan
 - ✓ Group C: Bengal and Assam
- Each group would frame its own constitutional arrangements and determine the subjects to be administered at the group level, in addition to the

limited Union subjects of defence, foreign affairs, and communications.

- For the Muslim League, this arrangement was of central strategic importance because Groups B and C created two consolidated Muslim-majority blocs, which could function as the constitutional foundation of a future Pakistan within a nominally united framework. Consequently, the League insisted that grouping was compulsory at the initial stage.
- Congress adopted a fundamentally different interpretation. Under pressure particularly from the Assam Congress and the Congress leadership in the NWFP, it argued that provinces retained the right to decide whether to join their assigned groups from the outset. This interpretation would have allowed NWFP to avoid Group B and Assam to avoid Group C, thereby undermining the League's strategic objective.
- The British interpretation aligned with the League's reading that initial grouping was mandatory. However, Congress refused to accept this construction. Jawaharlal Nehru's July 1946 statements, asserting that the Constituent Assembly would remain sovereign in interpreting constitutional arrangements, reinforced League suspicions that Congress intended to dilute or bypass the grouping provisions.
- This interpretational deadlock proved politically irreconcilable. The Muslim League withdrew its acceptance of the Cabinet Mission Plan and subsequently announced Direct Action, marking the effective collapse of the last major attempt to preserve a united constitutional transfer of power.

Q 112. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Mahatma Gandhi considered non-violence the fundamental principle of satyagraha.
- When protesters at Chauri Chaura killed policemen and burnt the police station, Gandhi feared that the movement was turning violent. Therefore, he withdrew the movement despite widespread public enthusiasm.
- Hence, both Assertion and Reason are true, and the Reason correctly explains the Assertion.

Q 113. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946, came first, called by Jinnah following the League's withdrawal

from the Cabinet Mission framework, triggering the Great Calcutta Killings and a chain of communal violence across Bengal and Bihar.

- Formation of the Interim Government, 2 September 1946, followed, with Nehru heading a Congress-dominated administration. The Muslim League initially boycotted before joining in October 1946 under Liaquat Ali Khan.
- First meeting of the Constituent Assembly, 9 December 1946, came third, boycotted entirely by the Muslim League, with Sachchidananda Sinha presiding as temporary President and Rajendra Prasad subsequently elected as permanent President.
- Attlee's Declaration, 20 February 1947, came last, with British Prime Minister Clement Attlee announcing that Britain would transfer power no later than June 1948 and appointing Lord Mountbatten as the new Viceroy to replace Wavell, setting a definitive deadline that dramatically accelerated the final negotiations over independence and partition.

Q 114. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Non-Cooperation Movement was withdrawn by Mahatma Gandhi on 12 February 1922 after the violent Chauri Chaura incident in Gorakhpur district, where protesters killed 22 policemen by setting a police station on fire.
- At the meeting of the All India Congress Committee held in Delhi on 24 February 1922, the Congress leadership approved Gandhi's decision to suspend the movement and emphasis was shifted towards constructive work.
- However, Balakrishna Shivram Moonje (Dr Moonje) strongly opposed Gandhi's action and tabled a vote of censure against him for abruptly withdrawing the movement.
- This reflected the growing division within nationalist ranks regarding Gandhi's strategy of absolute non-violence.

Q 115. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Balkan Plan, also called Plan Balkan, was Mountbatten's initial draft proposal for the transfer of power, named after the fragmented political geography of the Balkans. It envisaged transferring power separately to individual provinces and units, allowing each to decide its constitutional future

independently, whether by joining India, Pakistan, or potentially remaining independent.

- Jawaharlal Nehru, upon seeing the plan at Mountbatten's residence in Shimla in May 1947, immediately and strongly rejected it. Nehru recognised that the plan's logic would not produce a simple partition between India and Pakistan, but could potentially fragment the entire subcontinent into multiple independent political entities, with provinces and other territorial units pursuing separate constitutional destinies. This was the precise danger implied by the term Balkanisation.
- Nehru's rejection compelled Mountbatten and his constitutional adviser V.P. Menon to rapidly prepare an alternative framework, the 3 June Plan, which provided for the transfer of power to two clearly defined successor dominions, India and Pakistan, on the basis of Dominion Status within the British Commonwealth, thereby ensuring constitutional continuity and avoiding the wider territorial fragmentation feared under the earlier proposal.

Q 116. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Lahore was not visited by Gandhi during his communal peace efforts of 1946-47. Following partition, Lahore became part of Pakistan, and Gandhi's peace interventions during this period were concentrated in violence-affected regions where he was physically active within the Indian context of communal reconciliation.
- Noakhali in East Bengal was Gandhi's most prolonged and personally demanding peace mission. Following the communal violence against Hindus in October-November 1946, Gandhi arrived there in November 1946 and undertook an extended padyatra through affected villages, attempting through direct personal engagement to restore communal trust.
- Bihar witnessed severe retaliatory violence against Muslims following the Noakhali disturbances. Gandhi visited Bihar in early 1947 and exerted strong moral pressure to halt the violence, including threatening a fast unless communal peace was restored.
- Calcutta saw Gandhi's most dramatic peace intervention. During the independence period in August 1947, Gandhi remained in Calcutta rather than participating in celebrations in Delhi and used fasting as a moral instrument to stop communal

violence. The rapid restoration of peace following his intervention came to be widely described as the "Calcutta Miracle."

Q 117. Ans. C

Explanation:

- After the withdrawal of the Non-Cooperation Movement and the arrest of Mahatma Gandhi, many Congress leaders felt political stagnation had emerged.
- Chittaranjan Das and Motilal Nehru proposed that the Congress should enter the legislative councils established under the Government of India Act, 1919, and obstruct the colonial administration from within.
- When the majority within Congress rejected this proposal, C.R. Das resigned from the Congress presidency and formed the Swaraj Party in January 1923.
- C.R. Das became President of the party, while Motilal Nehru became its General Secretary.

Q 118. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Maharashtra Kisan Sabha, heavily spearheaded by communist leaders like Godavari Parulekar, officially organised and directed the Worli Adivasis against systemic landlord exploitation.
- The Independent Labour Party was founded by B.R. Ambedkar to focus primarily on Dalit political representation and labour rights.
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The revolt was concentrated in the Thana (Thane) district of the Bombay Presidency, specifically in Dahanu, Umbergaon (now Talasari), and Palghar talukas.
 - ✓ Warli Tribe: This region was richly populated by the Warli tribe, who formed more than half of the total population in Dahanu and Umbergaon taluks.
 - ✓ First Maharashtra Provincial Kisan Conference (January 1945): The ideological groundwork was laid during the First Maharashtra Provincial Kisan Conference at Titwala in January 1945.
 - ✓ The primary catalyst was the attempt to eradicate the institutionalised system of forced, unpaid labour known locally as veth begar.
 - ✓ Minimum Wage Demand: The organised Adivasis successfully executed a massive regional strike demanding a mandatory

minimum wage of 12 annas per day for forestry and grass-cutting work.

- ✓ **Leadership:** Godavari Parulekar (affectionately called “Godutai”) and her husband Shamrao Parulekar were the key leaders of the revolt.
- ✓ **Women’s Participation:** Worli women actively participated in the struggle, also suffering from landlord oppression.
- ✓ **Oppressive Forces:** The Warlis faced severe exploitation from powerful local landlords, timber merchants, and forest contractors who were backed by the colonial regime.
- ✓ **Violent Suppression Attempts:** Local timber contractors deployed heavily armed Pathan mercenaries to violently intimidate and break tribal labour strikes.
- ✓ **Government Response:** The British-administered Bombay provincial government deployed the armed Special Reserve Police to militarily suppress the expanding tribal unions.
- ✓ **Outcome:** Due to sustained organisational pressure, the movement successfully abolished the veth begar system across the entire district by late 1946 and established fixed wages for forest-based workers.
- ✓ **Literary Documentation:** Godavari Parulekar documented the sociopolitical dynamics in her definitive Marathi text, “Jevha Manus Jaga Hoto” (When Man Awakens).
- ✓ The primary, immediate catalyst for the tribal mobilisation was the absolute eradication of an institutionalised system of forced, unpaid labour known locally as veth begar.

Q 119. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Dr. B.R. Ambedkar founded the Independent Labour Party (ILP) on 15 August 1936, ahead of the provincial elections scheduled under the Government of India Act, 1935. The ILP was explicitly conceived to secure political and economic representation for the working class, particularly industrial labourers, agricultural workers, and the depressed classes, who remained largely unrepresented in mainstream political organisations.
- Ambedkar believed that the socio-economic oppression faced by Dalits and the class exploitation faced by workers were deeply interlinked, and the ILP was his attempt to forge a broader coalition that went beyond caste identity to address economic injustice as well.

- The party contested the 1937 provincial elections in the Bombay Presidency and performed remarkably well, winning 13 of the 17 seats it contested. The ILP also actively engaged in labour movements, notably supporting the 1938 textile mill workers’ strike in Bombay.
- The Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha (1924) was founded by Ambedkar much earlier, primarily to promote education and socio-cultural upliftment among the depressed classes, not as a political-electoral organisation for working-class representation.
- The All India Depressed Classes League was associated with other leaders of the depressed class movement and was not founded by Ambedkar.
- The Scheduled Castes Federation was founded by Ambedkar in 1942, later in his political journey, and was more narrowly focused on securing constitutional safeguards for the Scheduled Castes rather than broad working-class representation.

Q 120. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** In Hind Swaraj (1909), Gandhi argued that the real enemy was not merely British political rule but modern Western civilisation, which he believed was corrupting Indian society and values.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Gandhi criticised Western-style education and modern professions, arguing that they were undermining India’s ancient cultural and moral traditions.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Gandhi criticised railways in Hind Swaraj, stating that they had helped in spreading plague and famines by facilitating the movement of diseases and encouraging the export of food grains.

Q 121. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Communist Party of India had initially opposed British imperialism, but dramatically reversed its position after Germany invaded the Soviet Union in June 1941. The CPI now characterised World War II as a “People’s War” against fascism that deserved support, and consequently opposed the Quit India Movement as a dangerous disruption of the Allied war effort. This position severely damaged the CPI’s nationalist credentials and created lasting tensions between the party and the broader independence movement.

- The Muslim League under Jinnah refused to join the movement, viewing it primarily as a Congress attempt to force a political settlement with Britain on terms favourable to Congress and disadvantageous to Muslim political interests. Jinnah feared that a British withdrawal engineered by Congress alone would leave Muslims at the mercy of a Congress-dominated independent India without adequate constitutional safeguards.
- The Hindu Mahasabha under V.D. Savarkar also opposed the movement, urging Hindus to remain in government services, the military, and administrative positions rather than participate in civil disobedience. Savarkar's position was rooted in his belief that Indians should use wartime opportunities to acquire military training and institutional experience rather than court arrest and imprisonment.

Q 122. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Red Fort Trials of Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Kumar Sahgal, and Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon triggered an extraordinary wave of nationalist mobilisation across India, transcending religious, regional, and social divisions. The British intended the trials to portray the INA officers as traitors who had collaborated with the Axis powers, but the outcome was the exact opposite.
- The military tribunal found all three guilty and imposed severe punishments, including transportation for life. However, Commander-in-Chief General Claude Auchinleck, recognising the explosive public mood and the political risks of enforcing the sentences, ultimately remitted the punishments.
- Instead of delegitimising the INA, the trials elevated the accused officers into national icons of anti-colonial resistance. Public demonstrations, student protests, labour strikes, and widespread political agitation reflected how deeply the INA issue had resonated with the Indian public.
- The impact extended beyond civilian politics. The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of February 1946, influenced in part by the nationalist sentiment generated by the INA episode, signalled a dangerous erosion of British confidence in the loyalty of Indian armed forces. This was strategically alarming for the colonial state, as military reliability was the foundation of imperial control.

Q 123. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Interim Government was formed on 2 September 1946 under Jawaharlal Nehru's leadership, initially without the Muslim League, which had withdrawn from the Cabinet Mission framework and was observing Direct Action Day politics. The League's initial boycott was a deliberate strategy to delegitimise the Interim Government and resist what it saw as a Congress-dominated arrangement.
- However, in October 1946, the League reversed its position and joined the Interim Government, with Liaquat Ali Khan as Finance Minister and four other League members taking portfolios. The League's entry was not a gesture of reconciliation, it was a calculated political move to obstruct Congress governance from within, prevent the consolidation of a Congress-dominated administration, and maintain leverage in ongoing constitutional negotiations. Liaquat Ali Khan's use of the Finance portfolio to scrutinise and delay Congress-sponsored expenditure proposals became a notable example of this obstructionist strategy.
- The League's participation was thus fundamentally different from genuine coalition governance, the two parties functioned as adversaries within the same cabinet, with the League simultaneously sitting in the Interim Government and boycotting the Constituent Assembly, whose inaugural session on 9 December 1946 the League refused to attend. This contradictory position, inside the executive but outside the constituent body, reflected the League's broader strategy of paralysing the constitutional process unless its demand for Pakistan was conceded.

Q 124. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Under the Tinkathia System in Champaran, peasants were compelled by European indigo planters to cultivate indigo on 3/20th of their land.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The decline of natural indigo cultivation occurred due to the introduction of German synthetic dyes, not Japanese synthetic dyes. The synthetic alternatives reduced the demand for natural indigo in international markets.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Rajkumar Shukla, a local peasant leader from Champaran, persuaded

Mahatma Gandhi to visit the region and examine the problems faced by indigo cultivators under European planters.

Q 125. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Indian Independence Act was passed by the British Parliament in July 1947 and received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947, formally providing the legal framework for the transfer of power and the creation of two independent dominions on 14-15 August 1947.

Q 126. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Swarajists opposed the policy of council boycott and believed that nationalist representatives should enter legislative councils.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Their objective was not cooperation with the British government. Instead, they intended to obstruct and expose colonial governance from within the councils through debates, adjournments and resistance.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Motilal Nehru became the General Secretary of the Swaraj Party, while C.R. Das served as President.

Q 127. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Direct Action Day, observed on 16 August 1946, was called by Muhammad Ali Jinnah and the All India Muslim League after the League withdrew its acceptance of the Cabinet Mission Plan. The immediate political background was the breakdown of agreement over the interpretation of the Cabinet Mission's grouping provisions, particularly Congress's position that the Constituent Assembly would not be bound by compulsory grouping, which the League regarded as a repudiation of the Plan's core safeguards.
- Jinnah responded by declaring that the League would no longer rely solely on constitutional negotiation and would resort to "direct action" to secure the demand for Pakistan.
- The most immediate and devastating consequence was the outbreak of large-scale communal violence in Calcutta, known as the Great Calcutta Killings, where intense Hindu-Muslim rioting over several days caused thousands of deaths and extensive destruction.

- The violence did not remain confined to Calcutta. It was followed by major communal disturbances in Noakhali and later Bihar, creating a cycle of retaliatory violence that sharply deepened communal polarisation. These events profoundly altered the political environment and significantly strengthened the perception that constitutional coexistence within a united India was becoming increasingly unworkable.

Q 128. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Gopal Krishna Gokhale was an eminent moderate leader of the Indian National Congress and played an important role in India's early nationalist movement.
- Gandhi considered Gokhale as his political mentor and guide. After returning from South Africa, Gandhi received valuable guidance from Gokhale regarding Indian society, politics and the problems faced by common people.
- In 1912, Gokhale visited South Africa at Gandhi's invitation and closely observed Gandhi's struggle against racial discrimination.
- In his autobiography, Mahatma Gandhi referred to Gopal Krishna Gokhale as his mentor and political teacher.

Q 129. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Chittaranjan Das was popularly called "Desh Bandhu", meaning "Friend of the Nation".
- **Statement 2 is correct:** As a lawyer, he successfully defended Aurobindo Ghosh in the Alipore Bomb Conspiracy Case.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Vitthalbhai Patel became Speaker of the Central Legislative Assembly in 1925, not C.R. Das.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** C.R. Das advocated that Swaraj should serve the masses and not remain confined to privileged sections of society.

Q 130. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The resolution of Poorna Swaraj (Complete Independence) was adopted during the Lahore Session of the Indian National Congress in December 1929.
- The session was presided over by Jawaharlal Nehru.
- This marked a major shift in Congress's policy, as the demand changed from Dominion Status to Complete Independence from British rule.

Q 131. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jawaharlal Nehru presided over the Lahore Session of Congress in 1929.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Congress adopted the historic resolution of Poorna Swaraj during this session.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** On 31 December 1929, Jawaharlal Nehru hoisted the tricolour flag on the banks of the Ravi River at Lahore as a symbol of India's claim to independence.

Q 132. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The RIN mutiny began on February 18, 1946, when the ratings of HMIS Talwar, a shore establishment in Bombay, went on strike, protesting the poor quality of food and their discriminatory treatment by British officers. However, the immediate trigger was the act of B.C. Dutt, a naval rating and nationalist, who painted slogans including "Quit India" and "Jai Hind" on the establishment's premises. Dutt's arrest for this act of defiance directly ignited the ratings' refusal to comply with orders, setting off the mutiny on 18 February 1946.

Q 133. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Mahatma Gandhi travelled to South Africa in 1893 to work as a legal adviser for the Indian merchant Dada Abdulla.
- During his journey from Durban to Pretoria, Gandhi was forcibly removed from a first-class compartment at Pietermaritzburg railway station despite having a valid ticket.
- The incident became a turning point in Gandhi's life and played a significant role in shaping his struggle against racial discrimination and injustice.

Q 134. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Section A comprised the Hindu-majority provinces of Madras, Bombay, United Provinces, Bihar, Central Provinces, and Orissa. This grouping represented the principal Hindu-majority core of British India and was not the major source of constitutional controversy.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Section B comprised the northwestern Muslim-majority provinces of Punjab, NWFP, Sindh, and British Baluchistan.

This grouping was central to the Muslim League's acceptance of the Cabinet Mission Plan, as it provided the constitutional framework for a consolidated northwestern Muslim bloc.

- **Pair 3 is incorrectly matched:** Section C comprised Bengal and Assam, not Assam and NWFP. The North-West Frontier Province was placed in Section B, while Section C represented the eastern grouping. This arrangement became highly contentious, particularly because the Assam Congress opposed compulsory grouping with Bengal, fearing erosion of Assam's provincial autonomy within a larger grouping dominated by Bengal.

Q 135. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa in 1915 and later emerged as the leader of the Indian national movement.
- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** The Jallianwala Bagh massacre took place in April 1919 at Amritsar under General Dyer, not in 1918.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** The Lahore Session of the Indian National Congress in December 1929 adopted "Purna Swaraj" or complete independence as its ultimate goal under the presidency of Jawaharlal Nehru.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** The Dandi March began in March 1930 as part of the Civil Disobedience Movement against the British salt laws.

Q 136. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** On 16 December 1922, Madan Mohan Malaviya and Motilal Nehru decided to launch the Independent Party due to differences within the nationalist movement regarding participation in legislative councils after the suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Vithalbhai Patel became the first Indian President (Speaker) of the Central Legislative Assembly in 1925, an important milestone in the gradual Indianisation of colonial legislative institutions.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Vithalbhai Patel was associated with the Swaraj Party, which was founded by Motilal Nehru and Chittaranjan Das to enter legislative councils and oppose colonial policies from within the system.

Q 137. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Nehru Report recommended Dominion Status for India on the model of other self-governing dominions within the British Empire.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The report rejected the system of separate electorates. Instead, it proposed joint electorates with the reservation of seats for Muslims in provinces where they were in a minority.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The report recommended nineteen fundamental rights, including universal adult suffrage, equal rights for women, and the right to form unions.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** The report advocated the complete separation of State and religion, reflecting a secular constitutional framework.

Q 138. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Simon Commission arrived in Bombay on 3 February 1928. It had been appointed by the British Government under Prime Minister Stanley Baldwin to review the working of the Government of India Act, 1919 and suggest constitutional reforms for India.
- The Commission consisted entirely of British members and had no Indian representative. Due to this, Indians across political lines strongly opposed it and called it the "White Commission".
- Its arrival triggered nationwide protests, strikes, and demonstrations with the famous slogan "Simon Go Back".

Q 139. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny was eventually called off after negotiations in which Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel played a crucial role in persuading the ratings to surrender. The Naval Central Strike Committee was led by Signaller M.S. Khan as President, with Petty Officer Telegraphist Madan Singh as Vice President.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** During the uprising, the ratings lowered the British ensign and hoisted the flags of the Congress, Muslim League, and Communist Party. This was a powerful symbolic expression of anti-colonial unity, intended to demonstrate solidarity across communal and ideological lines in a common struggle against British rule.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The demand for Pakistan was not part of the strike committee's agenda. The ratings' political demands centred on national independence, better treatment, release of INA prisoners, and an end to colonial discrimination. The mutiny was framed as a broader anti-colonial revolt rather than a communal or partition-oriented movement.

Q 140. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Government of India Act, 1919, provided for the appointment of a statutory commission after ten years to review constitutional reforms.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Indians opposed the Simon Commission because all seven members were British and no Indian was included.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** In response to the challenge posed by the British, Indian leaders prepared the Nehru Report through an all-party committee under Motilal Nehru.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The Nehru Report demanded Dominion Status and not Complete Independence.

Q 141. Ans. C

Explanation:

- In its Madras Session held in December 1927, the Indian National Congress decided to boycott the Simon Commission because no Indian member had been included in it.
- The Congress viewed the Commission as an insult to Indian aspirations for self-government. As a result, protests were organised throughout the country when the Commission visited India in 1928.
- Even several other political groups and leaders joined the boycott movement, making it one of the major united protests of the national movement during the late 1920s.

Q 142. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Mountbatten Plan of 3 June 1947 formally provided for the transfer of power to two independent dominions, India and Pakistan, on the basis of Dominion Status within the British Commonwealth. This ensured constitutional continuity and avoided the legal uncertainty that an abrupt transfer without an established framework might have created.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Plan laid down a mechanism for partitioning Punjab and Bengal, the two major provinces with deeply mixed communal populations. Members of the provincial legislative assemblies were to meet in separate sections, representing Muslim-majority and non-Muslim-majority districts, and vote independently on whether partition should occur. If partition was approved, a Boundary Commission under Sir Cyril Radcliffe would demarcate the final boundary.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Mountbatten Plan did not provide for the compulsory merger or immediate abolition of princely states. It provided for the lapse of British paramountcy upon transfer of power, after which princely states would no longer be under British suzerainty. Their eventual accession to India or Pakistan was secured subsequently through the political and administrative efforts of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel and V.P. Menon.

Q 143. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Non-Cooperation Movement was launched in 1920 by Mahatma Gandhi to attain self-government through peaceful and non-violent means. Indians were urged to boycott foreign goods, government institutions and titles.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Khilafat Movement was started by Indian Muslim leaders to protest against the dismemberment of the Ottoman Empire and the weakening of the Caliph after World War I. Gandhi supported the movement to strengthen Hindu-Muslim unity.

Q 144. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Lala Lajpat Rai was popularly known as "Punjab Kesari" because of his fearless leadership and contribution to the nationalist movement in Punjab.
- He played an important role in the anti-colonial struggle and was one of the famous Lal-Bal-Pal trio consisting of Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, and Bipin Chandra Pal.
- During protests against the Simon Commission in Lahore, he was severely injured in a police lathi charge and later succumbed to his injuries. His death became a major turning point in the revolutionary movement.

Q 145. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Gandhi and other members of the Congress Working Committee were released unconditionally on 25 January 1931 by the British Government.
- Their release was intended to create a favourable atmosphere for negotiations between the Congress leadership and the colonial administration following the intense phase of the Civil Disobedience Movement.
- After the release, the Congress Working Committee authorised Gandhi to hold discussions with the Viceroy, eventually leading to the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.

Q 146. Ans. C

Explanation:

- B. R. Ambedkar was the only Indian leader who participated in all three Round Table Conferences held in London between 1930 and 1932.
- He represented the interests of the Depressed Classes and strongly advocated political safeguards, separate electorates, and social justice measures for marginalised communities.
- His participation in all three conferences established him as one of the most influential constitutional voices in late colonial India.

Q 147. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Gandhi-Irwin Pact is also known as the Delhi Pact because it was signed in Delhi in 1931 between Gandhi and Lord Irwin.
- The agreement marked an important phase in the Indian national movement as it temporarily suspended the Civil Disobedience Movement and opened the path for Congress participation in constitutional discussions.
- The pact also enhanced the political legitimacy of the Congress by placing it on an equal negotiating footing with the British Government.

Q 148. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Gandhi undertook his 21-day fast in February 1943 while imprisoned at the Aga Khan Palace, Pune, primarily in response to the British government's accusation, particularly under Viceroy Lord Linlithgow, that Gandhi and the Congress were responsible for the widespread violence that

followed the Quit India Movement. This violence included attacks on railways, telegraph lines, police stations, and other government installations after the mass arrests under Operation Zero Hour.

- Gandhi firmly rejected this charge. He maintained that the violence was not the product of any Congress directive, but a spontaneous reaction to the British government's own repressive actions in arresting the entire national leadership and suppressing legitimate political expression. Through the fast, Gandhi sought to assert his moral innocence, protest the British misrepresentation of Congress's role, and place responsibility for the deteriorating situation squarely on the colonial government.

Q 149. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Champaran movement was launched by Mahatma Gandhi in 1917 in Bihar against the exploitative tinkathia system imposed on indigo cultivators by European planters.
- It was the first major satyagraha movement led by Gandhi in India after his return from South Africa in 1915.
- The success of the movement established Gandhi as a mass leader in Indian politics.

Q 150. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Operation Polo, launched in September 1948, was the military action undertaken by the Indian government against Hyderabad, the largest and wealthiest princely state, ruled by Nizam Mir Osman Ali Khan. The Nizam had refused to accede to India, instead seeking either independence or a special treaty arrangement, while negotiations continued inconclusively. Simultaneously, the Razakars, a militant force led by Qasim Razvi and associated with the Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen, intensified violence and instability within Hyderabad and along adjoining Indian territories.
- Sardar Patel, after the failure of prolonged negotiations, authorised military intervention under Major General J.N. Chaudhuri. The operation lasted from 13 to 18 September 1948, ending with Hyderabad's surrender. The Indian government officially described the intervention as a "police action" rather than a war.
- Hyderabad was thereafter integrated into the Indian Union, and the Nizam was retained in a constitutional capacity as Rajpramukh, not Governor.

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